FYP · BS COMPUTER SCIENCE · INSTITUTE OF SPACE TECHNOLOGY

DriveSync

Desktop UI Design

A dark glass interface for a real-time desktop search engine on Windows. Complete screen set, design system and interaction flows.

PREPARED BY

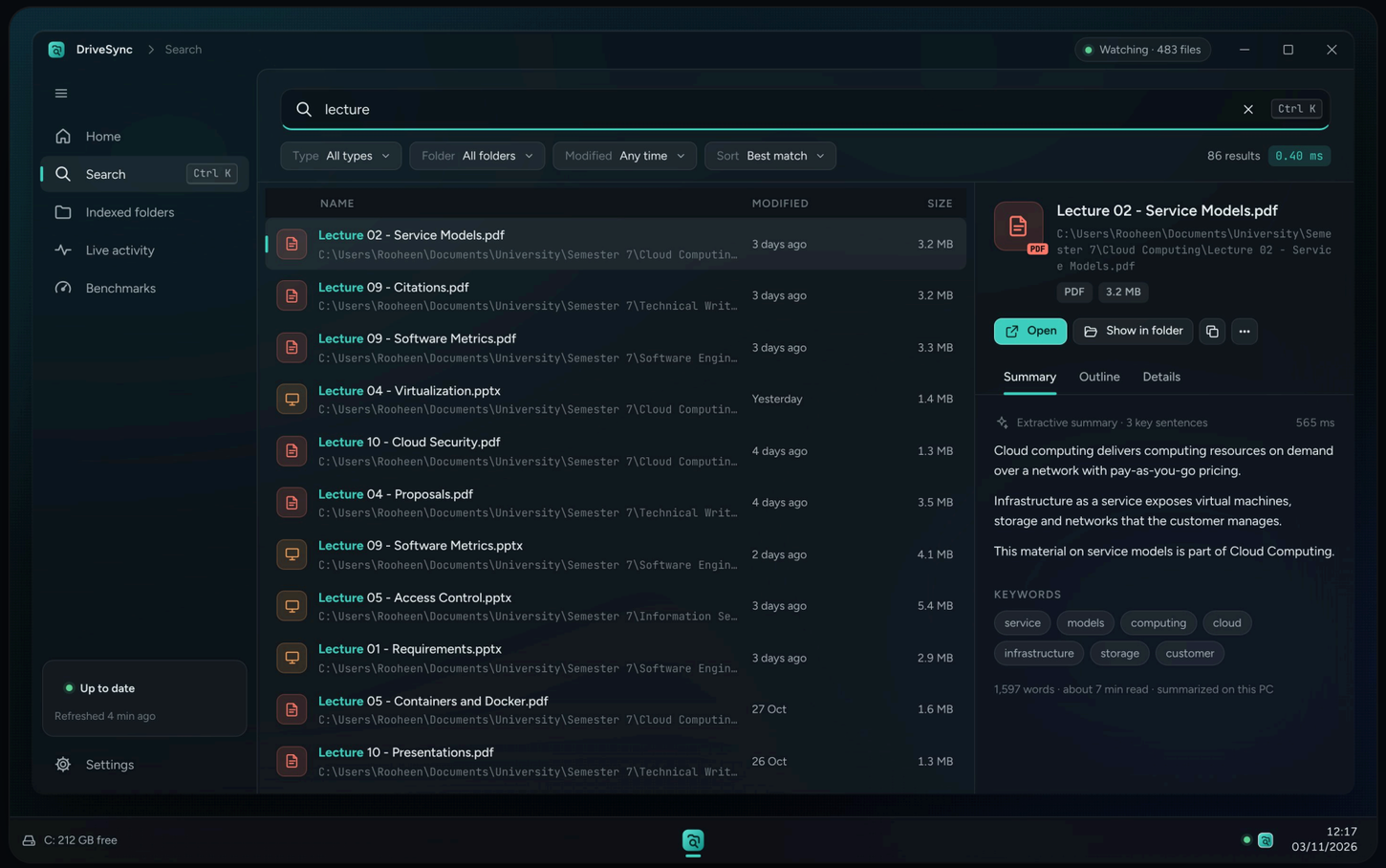
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SUPERVISOR

Mr. Faran Mehmood

VERSION

0.9 prototype · November 2026



OVERVIEW

Design direction

Search is the product

The search box is reachable from every screen (Ctrl K, Alt Space globally). Results appear as you type, with the lookup time shown beside the count so speed is visible, not claimed.

Confirm before opening

The preview pane answers “is this the right file?” with an extractive summary, an outline of headings or code symbols, and file details. Files are read only when selected.

Status you can trust

Indexing state appears in the title bar, the navigation card, the tray and the pipeline. Locked files, offline drives and size limits each get a specific explanation and a next step.

Windows 11, not a copy

Mica window surface, acrylic menus and dialogs, Fluent pill indicators, 46-px caption buttons and a taskbar. The identity comes from the DriveSync deck's teal and a geometric display face.

Offline by design

Copy says plainly that nothing leaves the PC. Settings carry an Offline badge and show where the SQLite index lives.

Keyboard first

Arrow keys through results, Enter to open, Shift F10 for actions, Alt 1–6 between pages, Esc to dismiss. Every control has a visible focus ring.

Screen inventory

Home 2 screens	**Search & preview** 13 screens	**Indexed folders** 5 screens	**Live activity** 1 screen	**Benchmarks** 1 screen	**Settings** 4 screens	**First-run setup** 4 screens	**Window & system** 2 screens

DESIGN SYSTEM · 1

Color & materials

Ground & surfaces

Wallpaper
`--wall-1`
`#05070a`

Mica window
`--mica · --glass`
`rgb(16 21 27 / .74)`

Layer 1
`--layer`
`rgba(255,255,255,.035)`

Layer 2
`--layer-2`
`rgba(255,255,255,.06)`

Layer 3
`--layer-3`
`rgba(255,255,255,.09)`

Stroke
`--stroke`
`rgba(255,255,255,.075)`

Text

Primary
`--text`
`#e8eef0`

Secondary
`--text-2`
`#a3afb4`

Tertiary
`--text-3`
`#6c787d`

Accent

DriveSync teal
`--accent`
`#3fd0c0`

Accent soft
`--accent-soft`
`teal 15%`

On accent
`--text-on-accent`
`#062421`

Users can switch the accent in Settings (Teal, Sky, Iris, Amber, Rose, Lime). Every accent-tinted surface derives from `--accent` with `color-mix()`.

Semantic

Success
`--ok`
`#5fd394`

Warning
`--warn`
`#f2c25c`

Error
`--err`
`#ff6f6f`

File types

Word · PDF · Sheet · Slides · Code · Text · Image · Data · Archive

Materials

Mica
Window · blur 40 · saturate 140% · alpha 0.55–0.97 (user slider)

Acrylic
Menus, dialogs, toasts · blur 30–40 · rgba(34,40,46,.92)

Type, space & shape

Typefaces

Sora — Display. Page titles, stat numbers, dialog titles. Segoe UI Variable Display on Windows.

Figtree — Body and controls. Segoe UI Variable Text on Windows.

JetBrains Mono — Paths, timings, tokens, shortcuts. Cascadia Code on Windows.

Scale

--fs-2xl	34px	Good afternoon
--fs-xl	26px	Indexed folders
--fs-lg	19px	Clear the index?
--fs-md	15px	Recently changed
--fs-body	13.5px	Search 551 files across 5 folders.
--fs-sm	12.5px	Refreshed 4 min ago
--fs-cap	11.5px	FILES · MODIFIED · SIZE

Spacing (4-px grid)

--s1	4px
--s2	8px
--s3	12px
--s4	16px
--s5	20px
--s6	24px
--s8	32px

Corner radius



--r-sm
4px · chips, kbd

--r-md
8px · buttons, inputs, rows

--r-lg
12px · cards, window

--r-xl
16px · dialogs, hero search

Elevation

1 Selected segment

2 Hero search, raised cards

3 Menus, toasts

4 Window, dialogs

Motion

180 ms for hover and state, 220–280 ms for views and dialogs, easing cubic-bezier(.2,.8,.2,1). Respects the system “reduce motion” setting and an in-app switch.

Components & states

Buttons

Rest	Refresh index	Add folder	Manage	Remove	
Hover	Refresh index	Add folder	Manage	Remove	
Pressed	Refresh index	Add folder			
Disabled	Refresh index	Add folder			
Focus	Add folder				

Inputs

Rest

C:\Users\Rooheen\Desktop

Focus

C:\Users\Rooheen\Desk

Error

Desktop

Use a full Windows path that starts with a drive letter.

Selection

Checked Off

All Added Modified

Menus & filters

Type All types Sort Best match

- All types
- Open Enter
- Copy path Ctrl+Shift+C
- Exclude this folder

Status & tags

Watching Paused Scanning 45%

Drive not found

proposal virtualization Ctrl K

0.21 ms

Watching · 551 files Rebuilding index 46%

Feedback

Desktop is indexed

66 files added. DriveSync will keep it up to date.

Search it

Some results are on E:\, which isn't connected.

Navigation & result row

- Search
- Indexed folders
- Live activity 3

Lecture 05 - Virtualizat… C:\Users\Rooheen\Docu…	16 days ago	2.3 MB
IndexEngine.cs C:\Users\Rooheen\Docu…	Yesterday	14 KB

Selected (accent pill + Layer 2) · Hover (Layer 1) · matched prefix in accent

INTERACTION

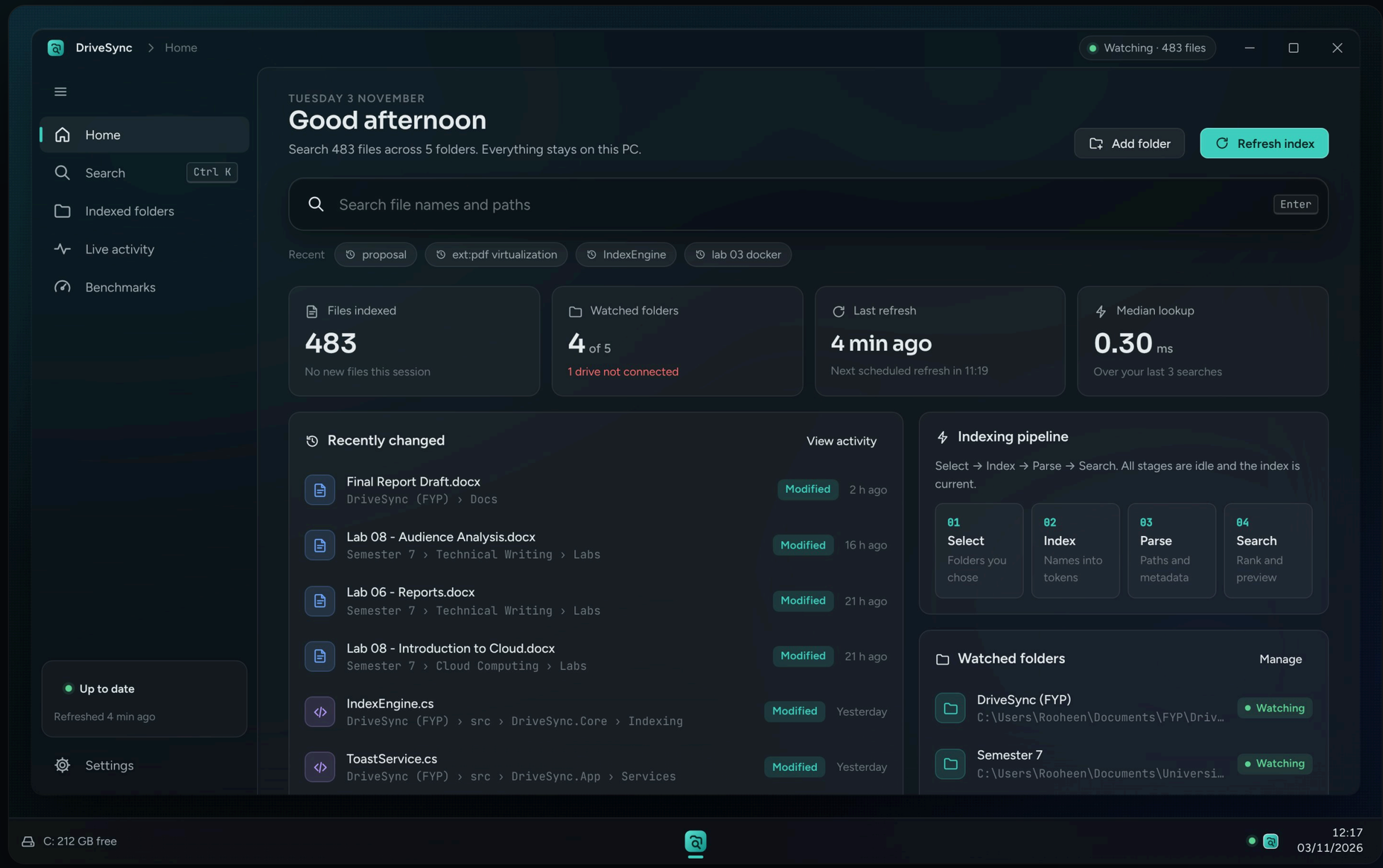
Key flows

Find a file	Home search or Ctrl K	→	Type: results update as you type	→	↑ ↓ through results	→	Preview: Summary · Outline · Details	→	Open · Show in folder · Copy path
Add a folder	Indexed folders	→	Add folder dialog	→	Path validated inline	→	Scanning: progress in table, title bar, nav	→	Toast with “Search it”
Stay current	File changes on disk	→	Watcher queues the event	→	Index updates	→	Live activity row + nav badge	→	Result tagged “New”
Recover from a reset	Settings → Clear index	→	Confirm with acknowledgement	→	Empty-index state in Search	→	Rebuild	→	“Index rebuilt” toast
Run in the background	Close button	→	Window hides, service keeps watching	→	Tray flyout: status, Pause, Refresh	→	Open DriveSync	→	Window restored
First run	Welcome	→	Choose folders	→	Build index: Select → Index → Parse → Search	→	Ready	→	Search with focus in the box

Navigation: Home · Search · Indexed folders · Live activity · Benchmarks · Settings (Alt 1–6). Every page also reachable from the title-bar status chip (Live activity) and from links inside Home cards.

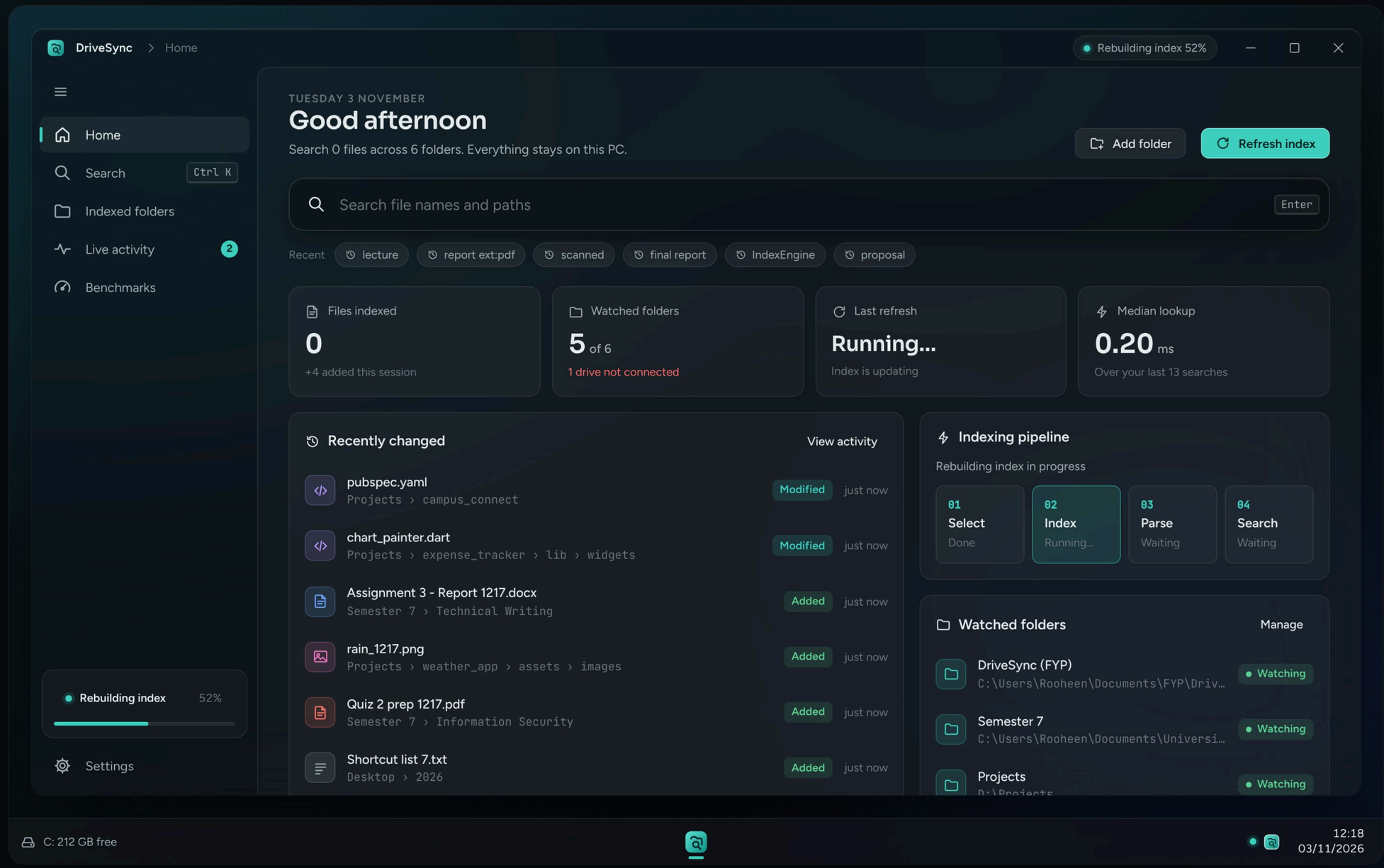
Home

Greeting, quick search, index stats, recently changed files, the four-stage pipeline and watched folders.



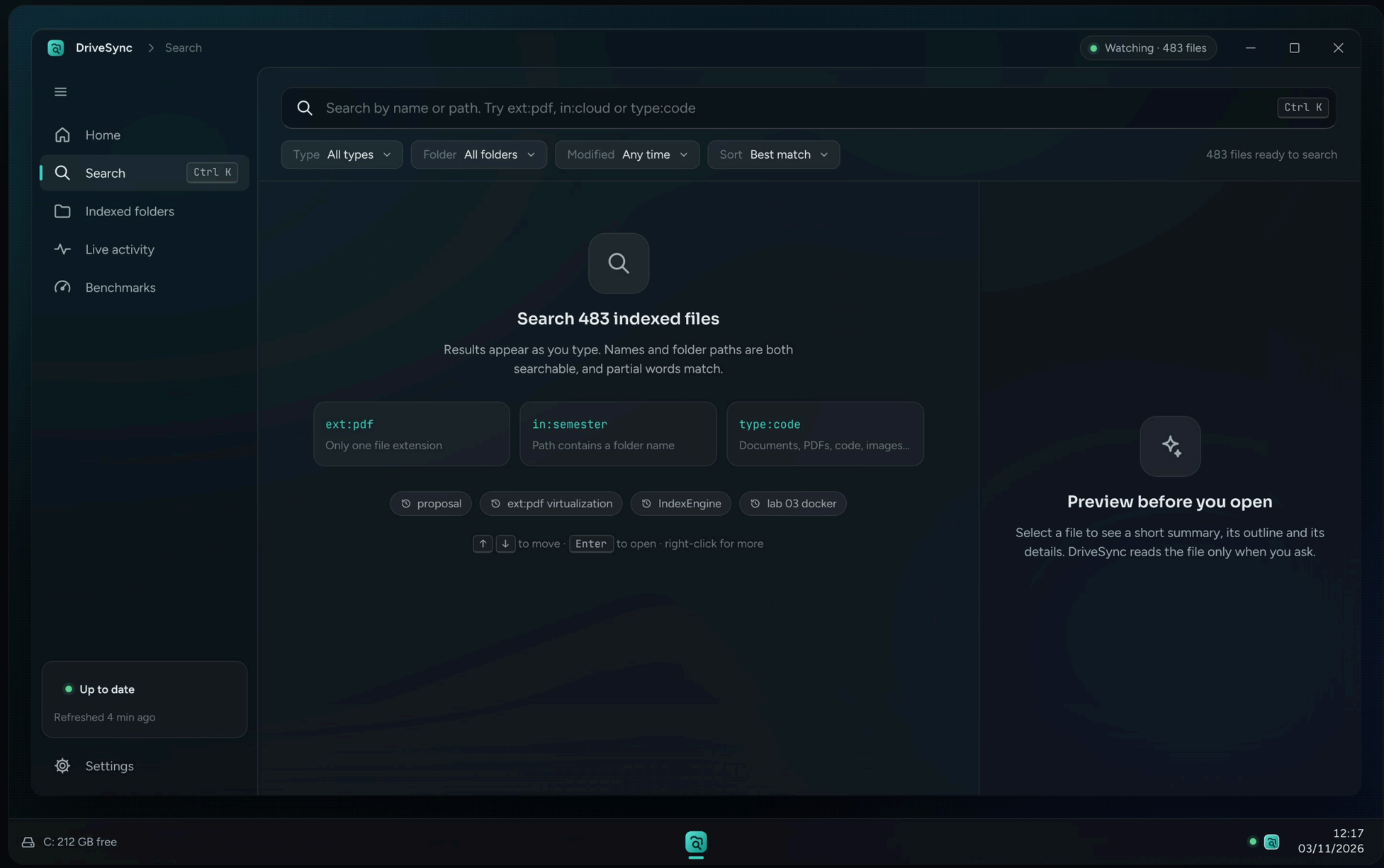
Home · rebuilding

Progress shows in the title bar, the navigation card and the pipeline.



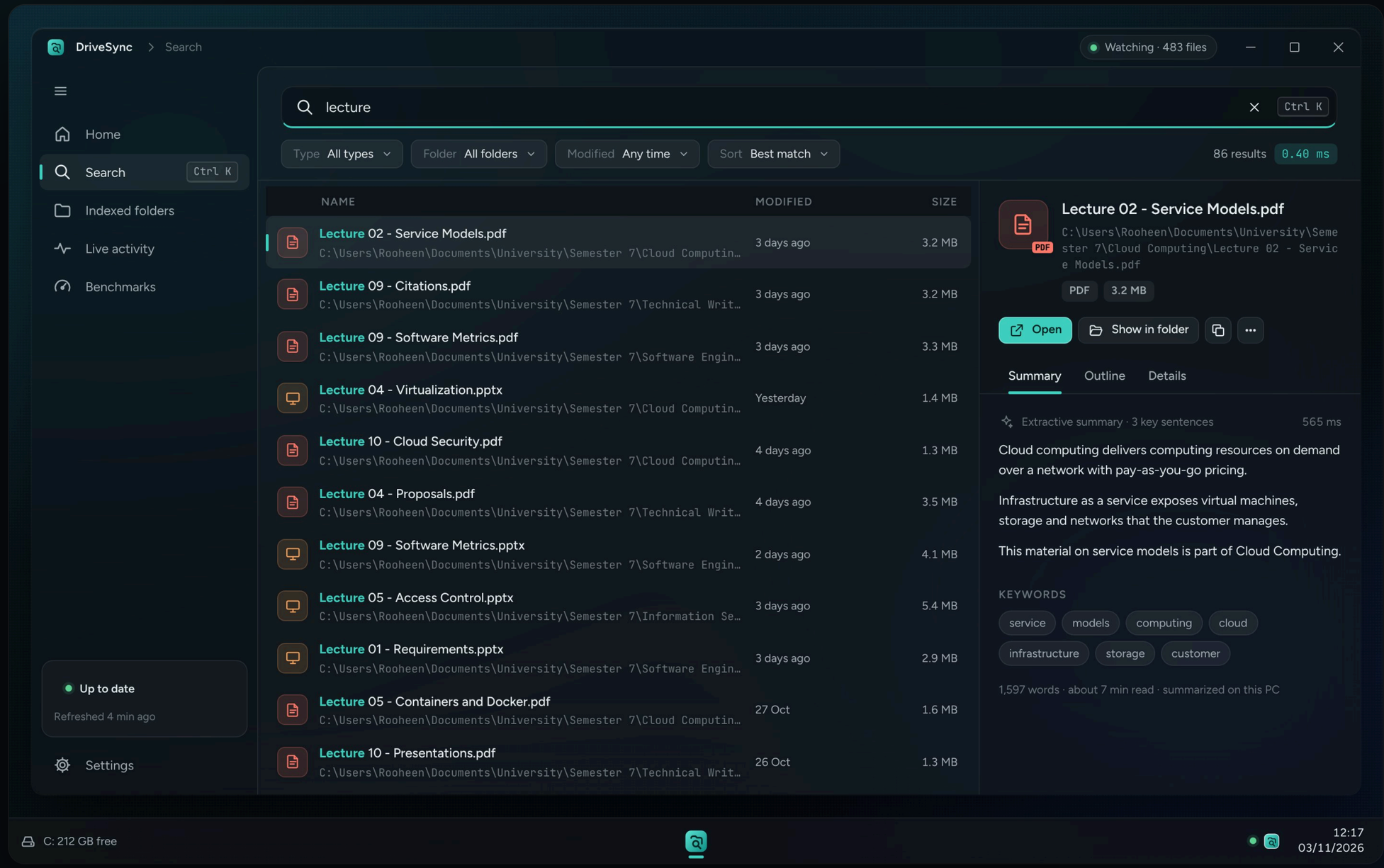
Search · ready state

Empty search explains operators and offers recent searches.



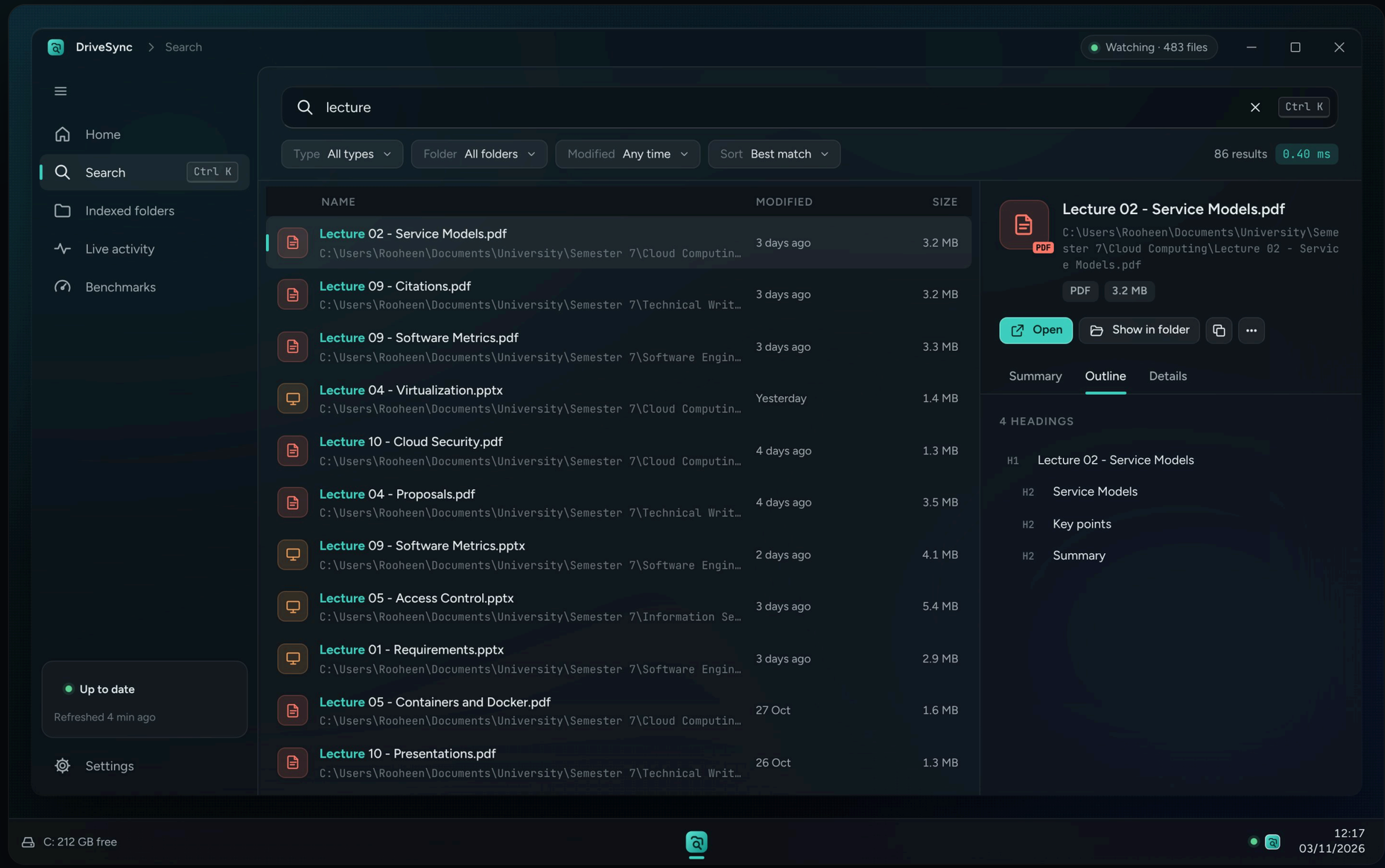
Search · results with summary

Live results with match highlighting, lookup timing, and an extractive summary of the selected PDF.



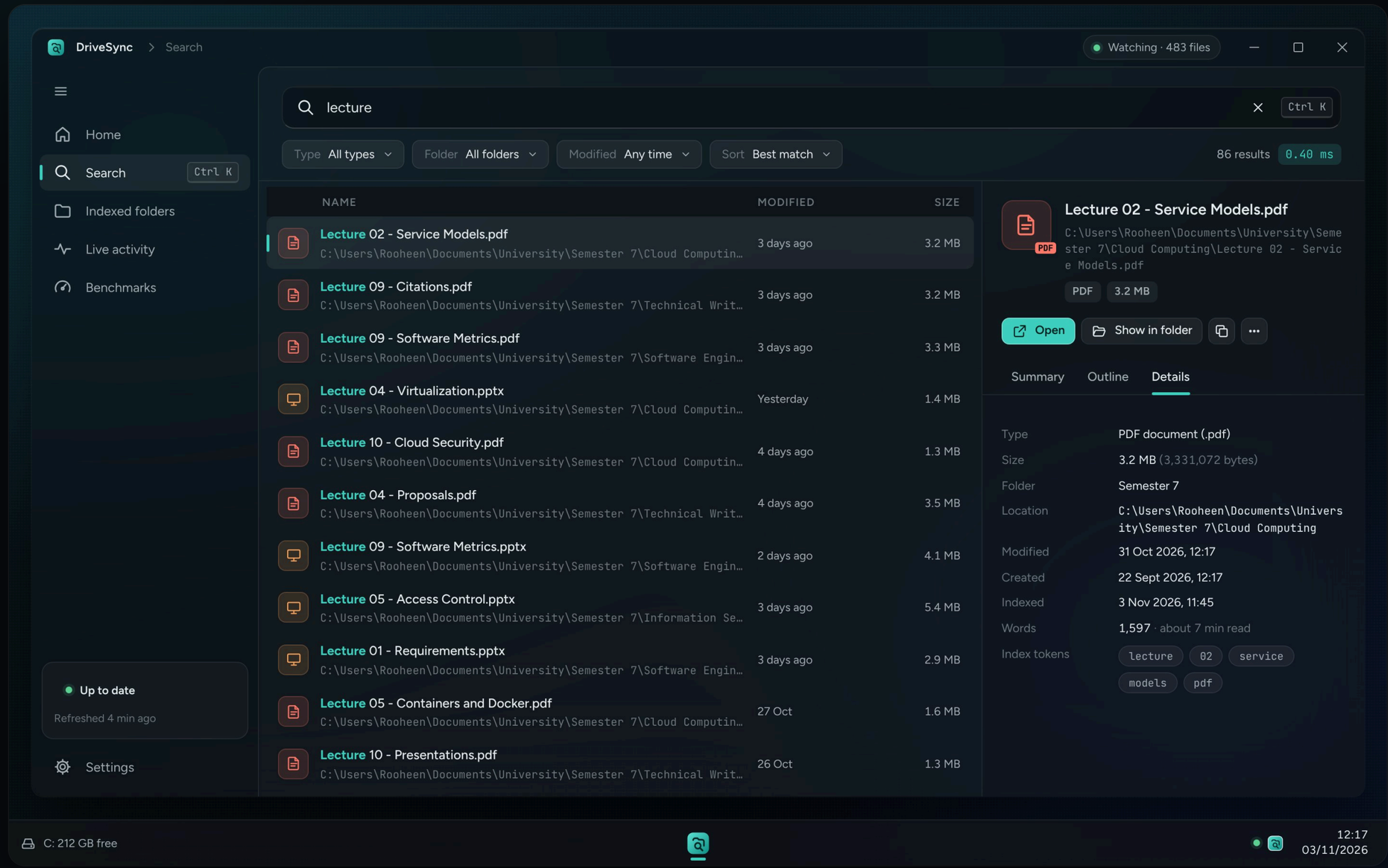
Preview · outline

Headings pulled from the file give a structural overview.



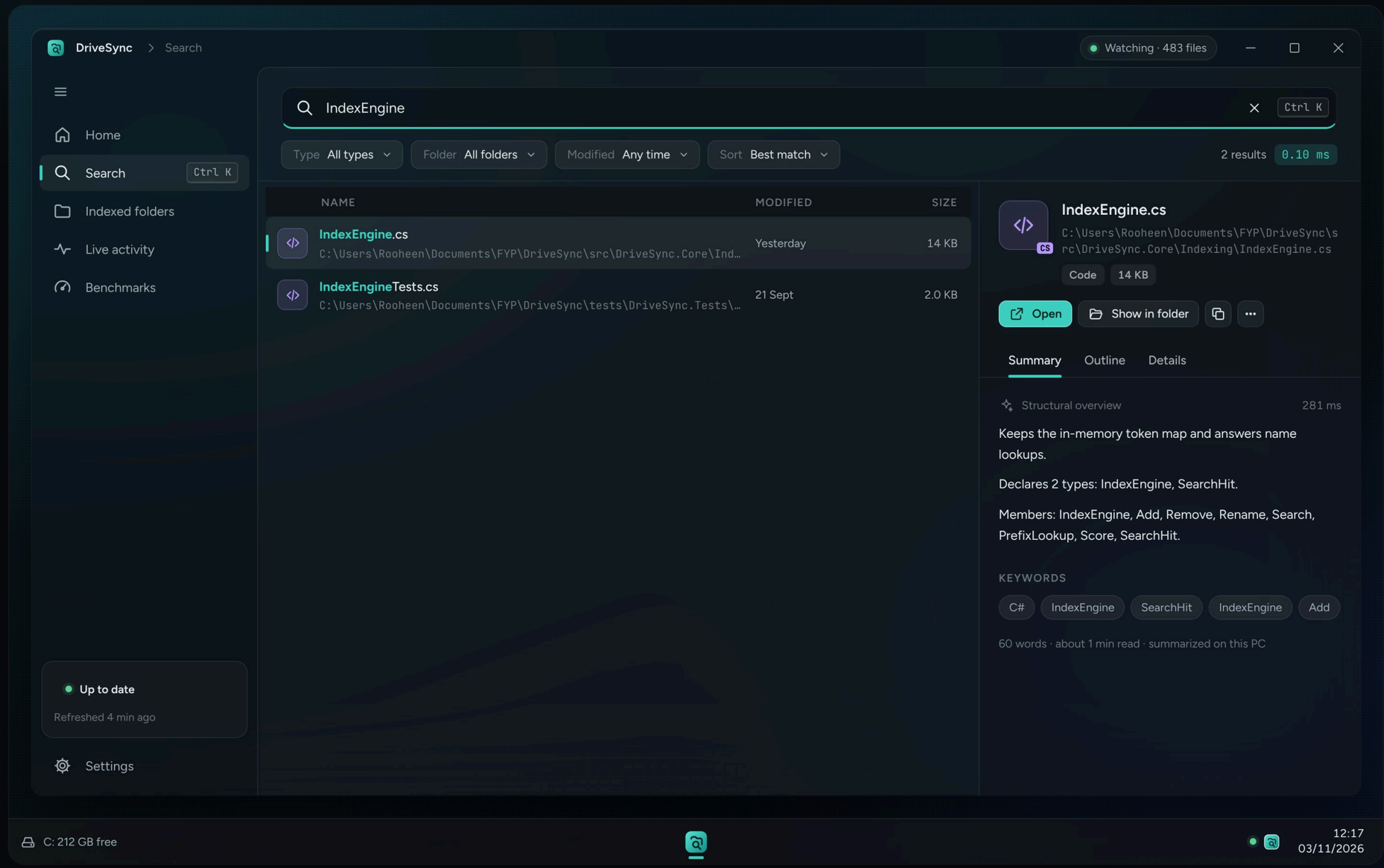
Preview · details

Metadata and the tokens the file is indexed under.



Preview · code file

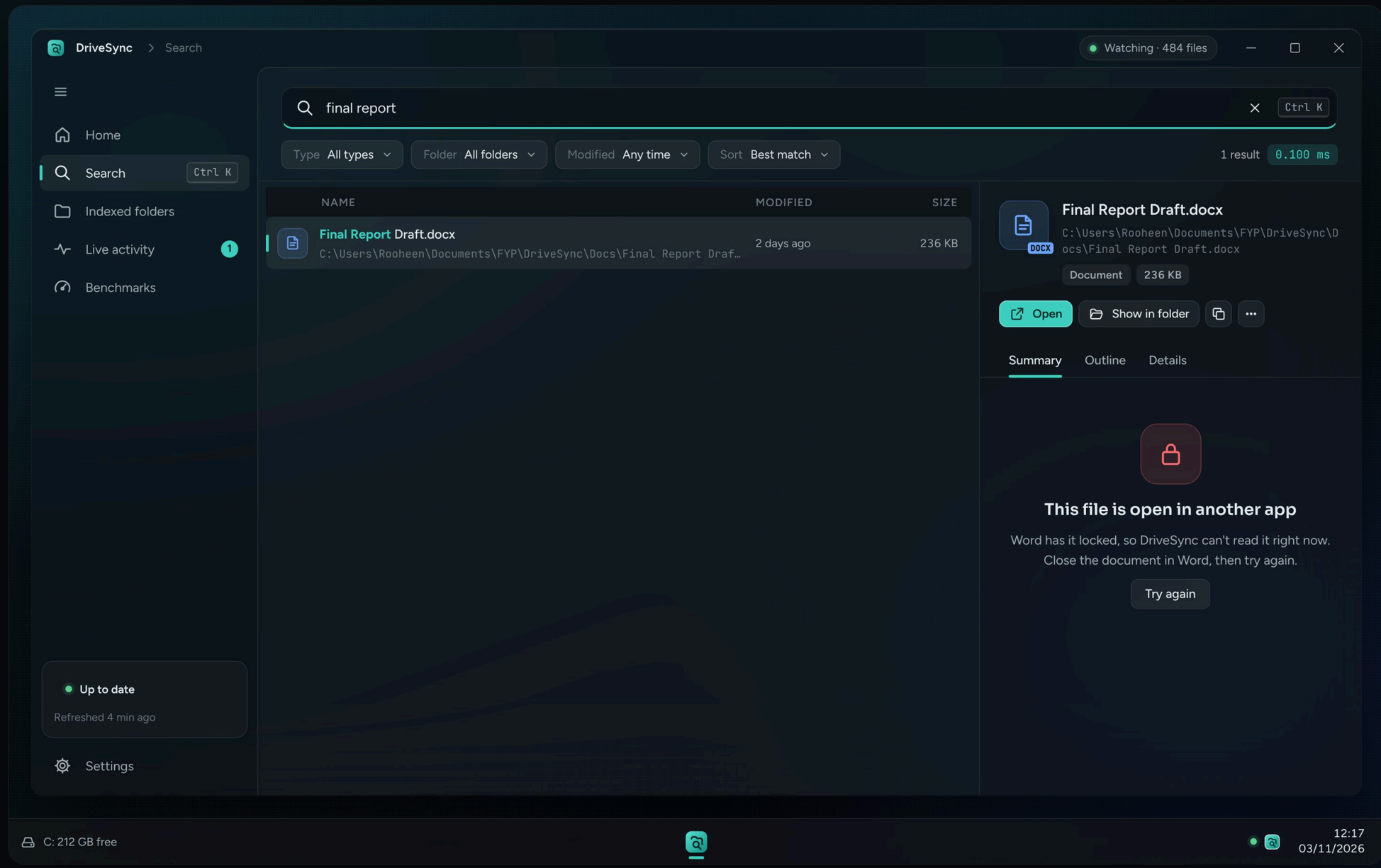
Source files get a structural overview of types and members.



SEARCH & PREVIEW · 08

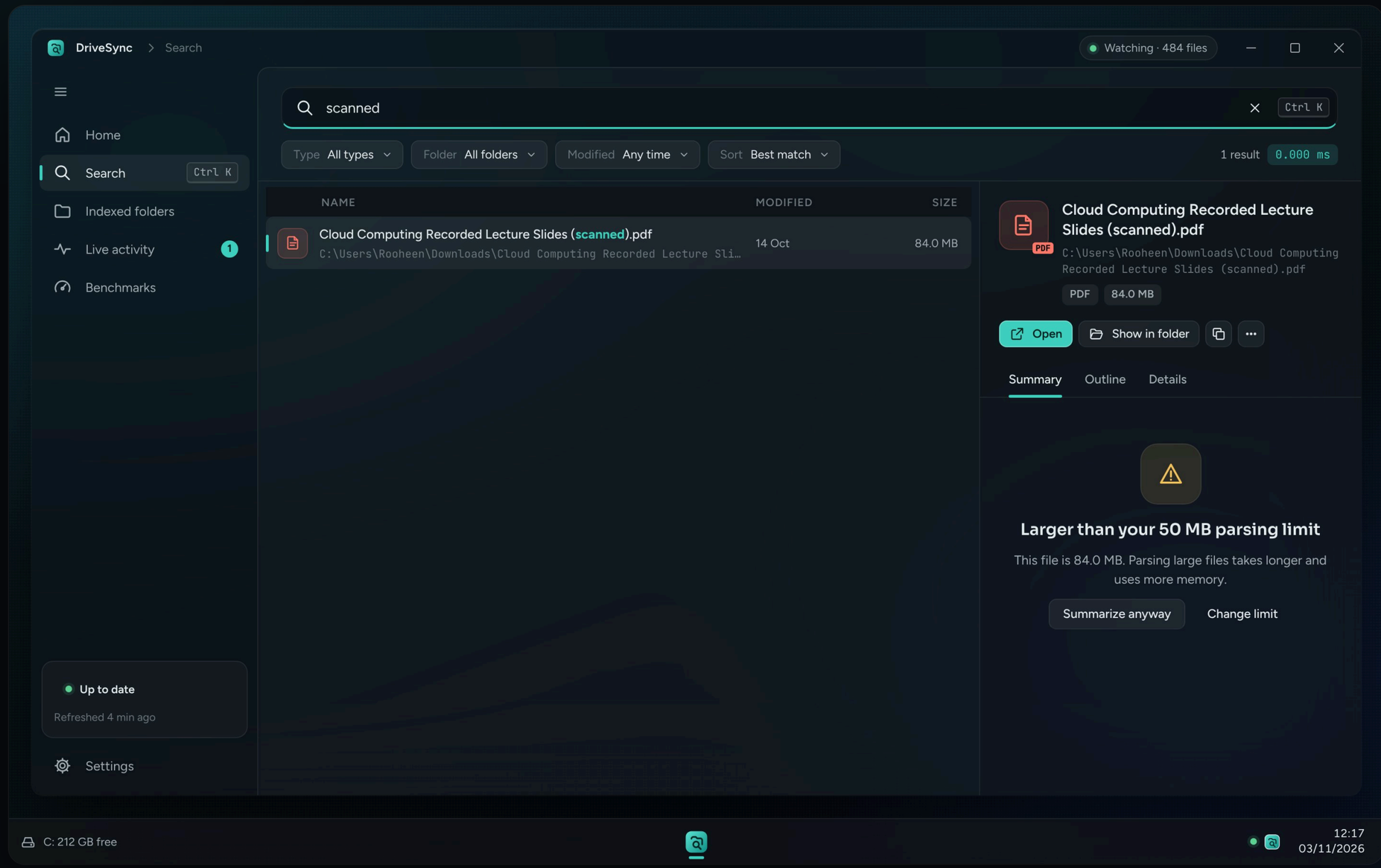
Preview · error: file locked

A file open in Word explains the lock and offers a retry.



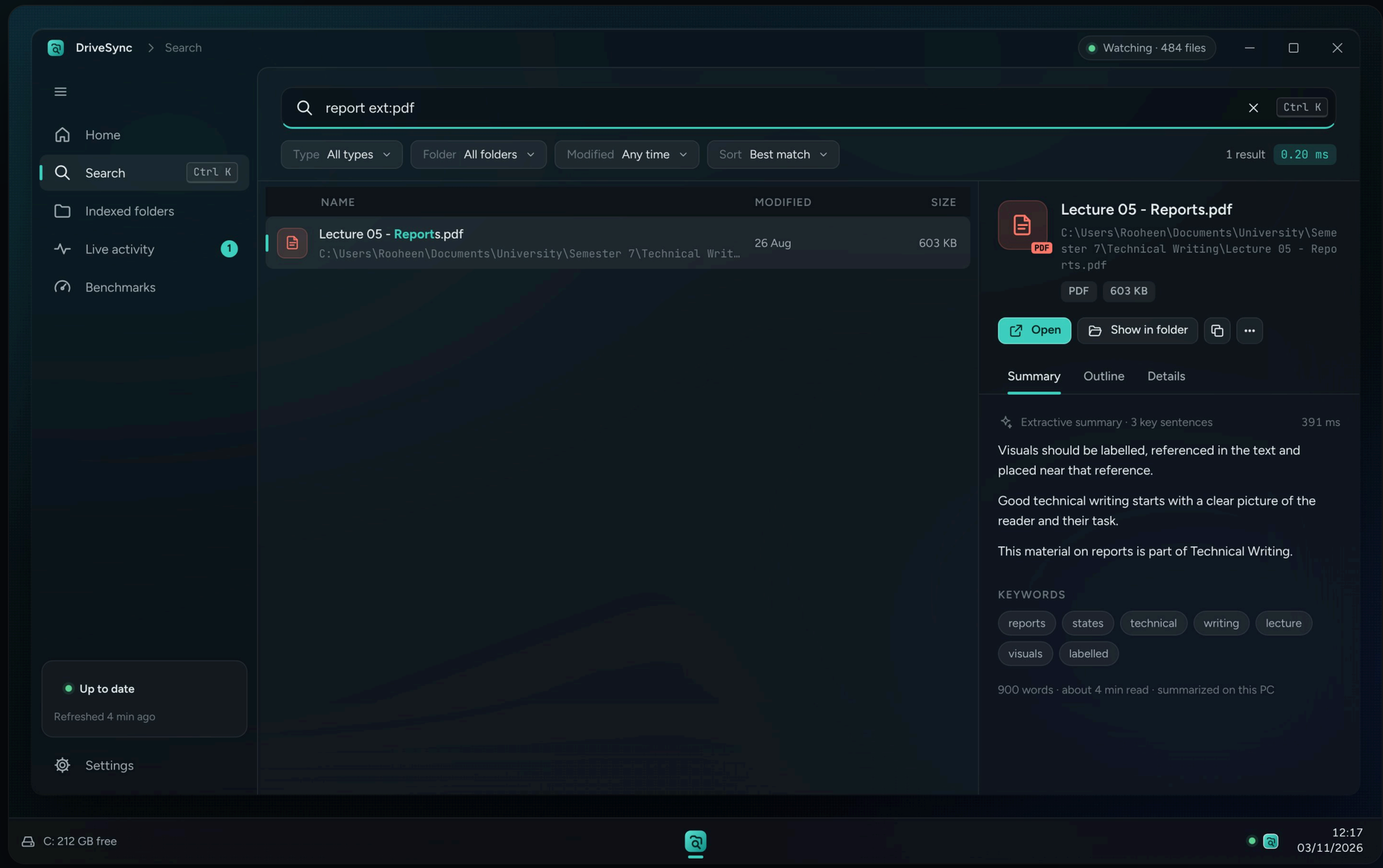
Preview · warning: size limit

Files above the parsing limit can still be summarized on request.



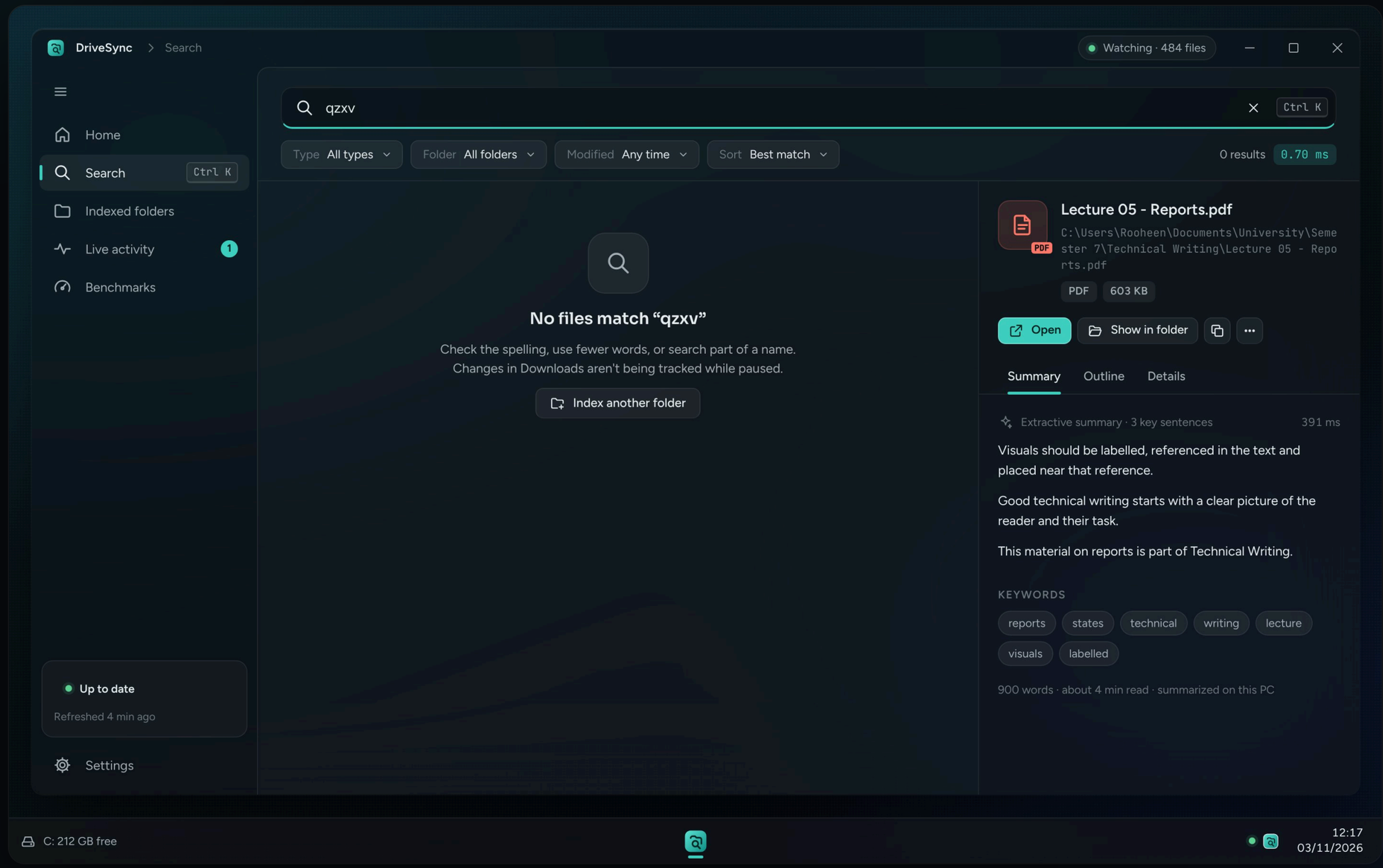
Search · offline drive

Results from a disconnected drive stay visible but are marked offline.



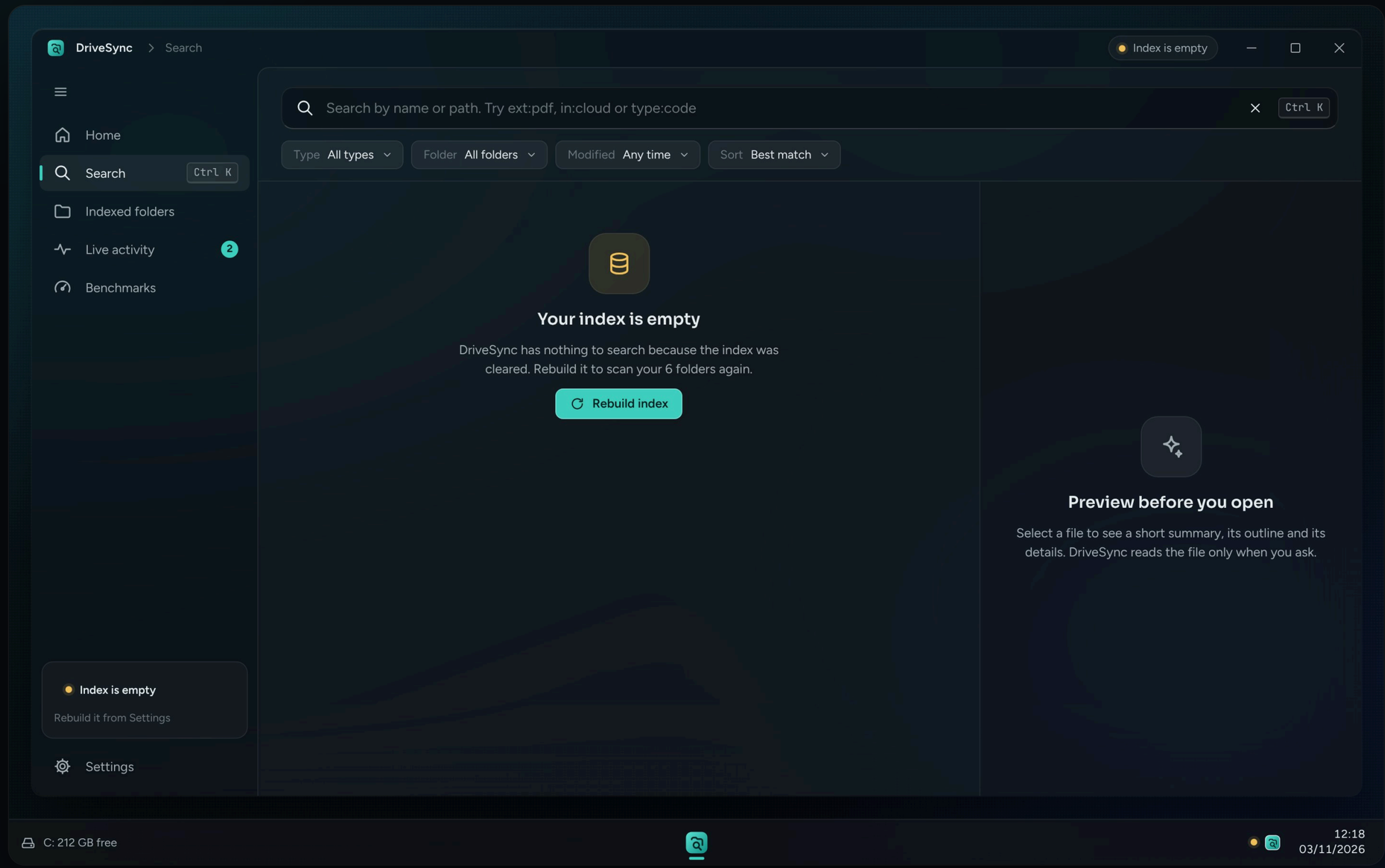
Search · no results

No-match state with ways forward.



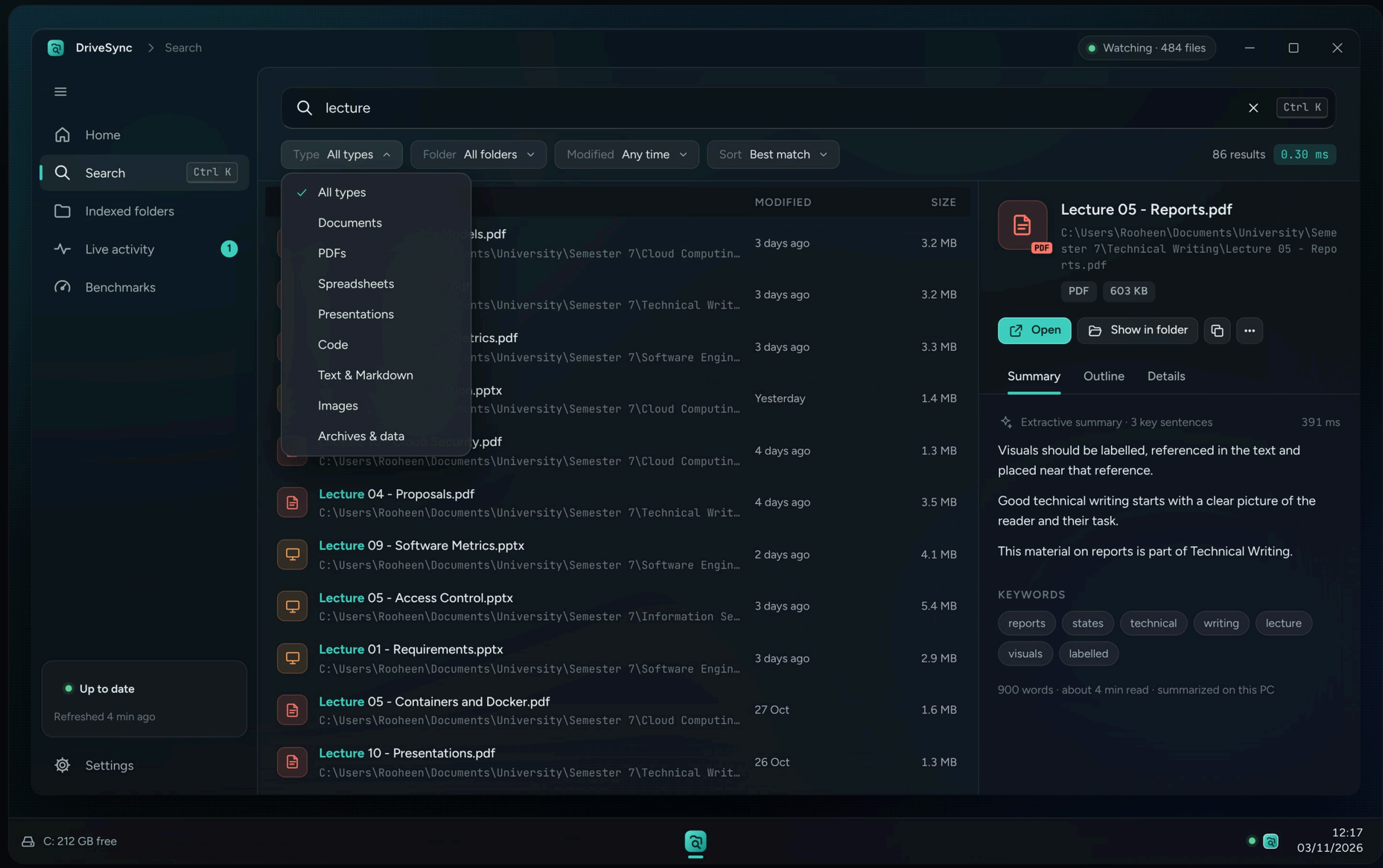
Search · empty index

After clearing, search explains why and offers a rebuild.



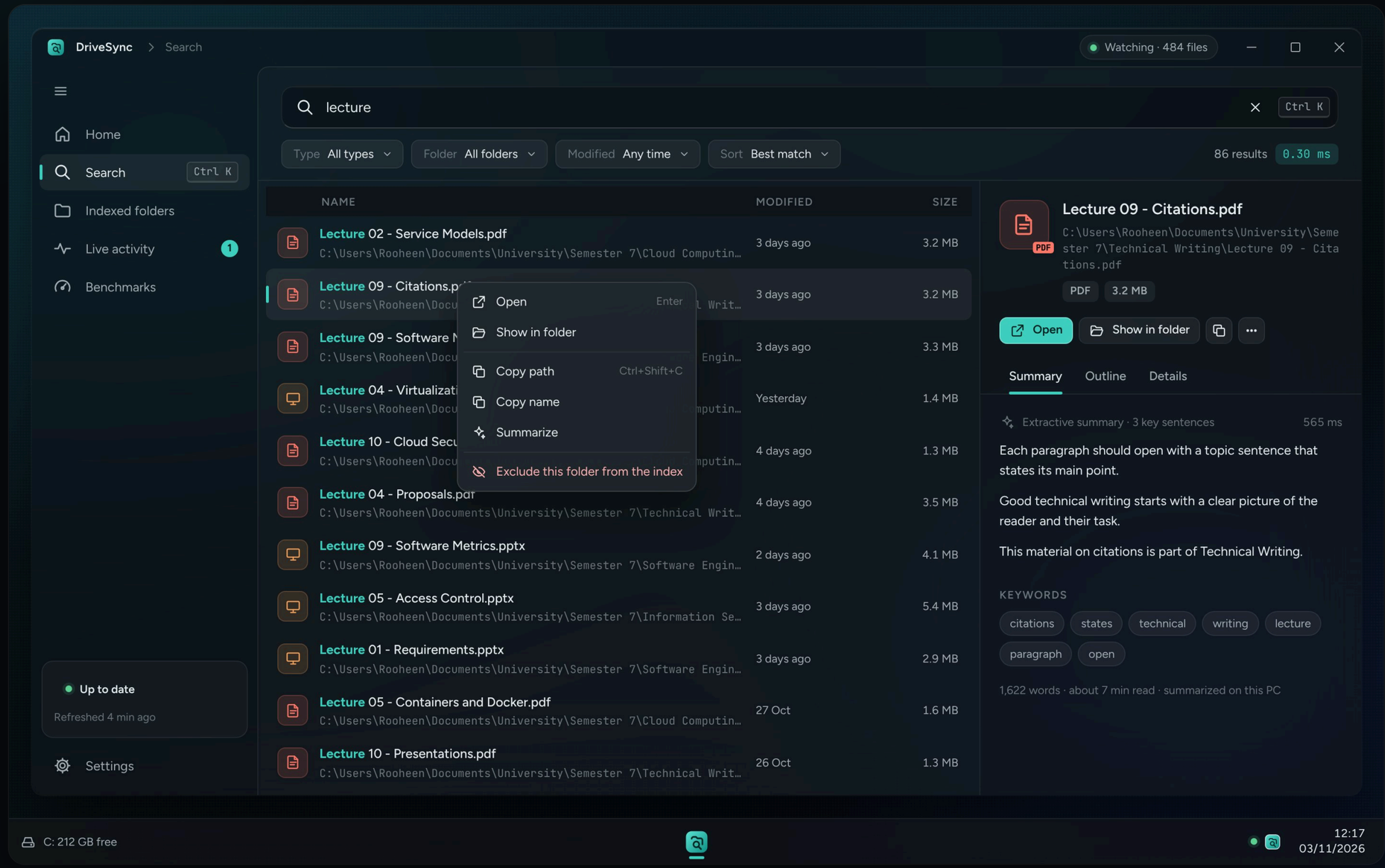
Filters · dropdown menu

Type, folder, date and sort filters use Fluent-style menus.



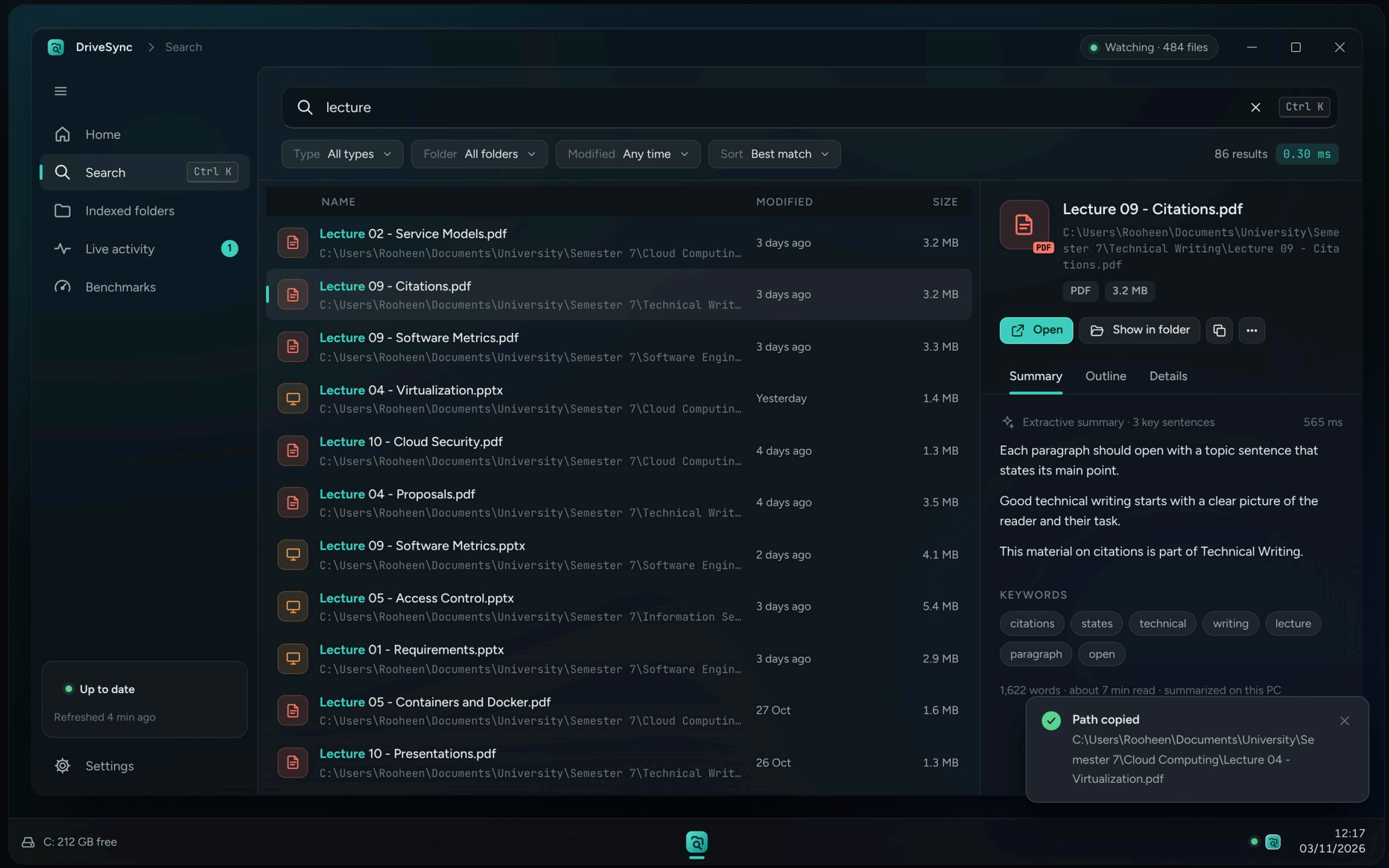
Search · context menu

Right-click actions: open, show in folder, copy, summarize, exclude.



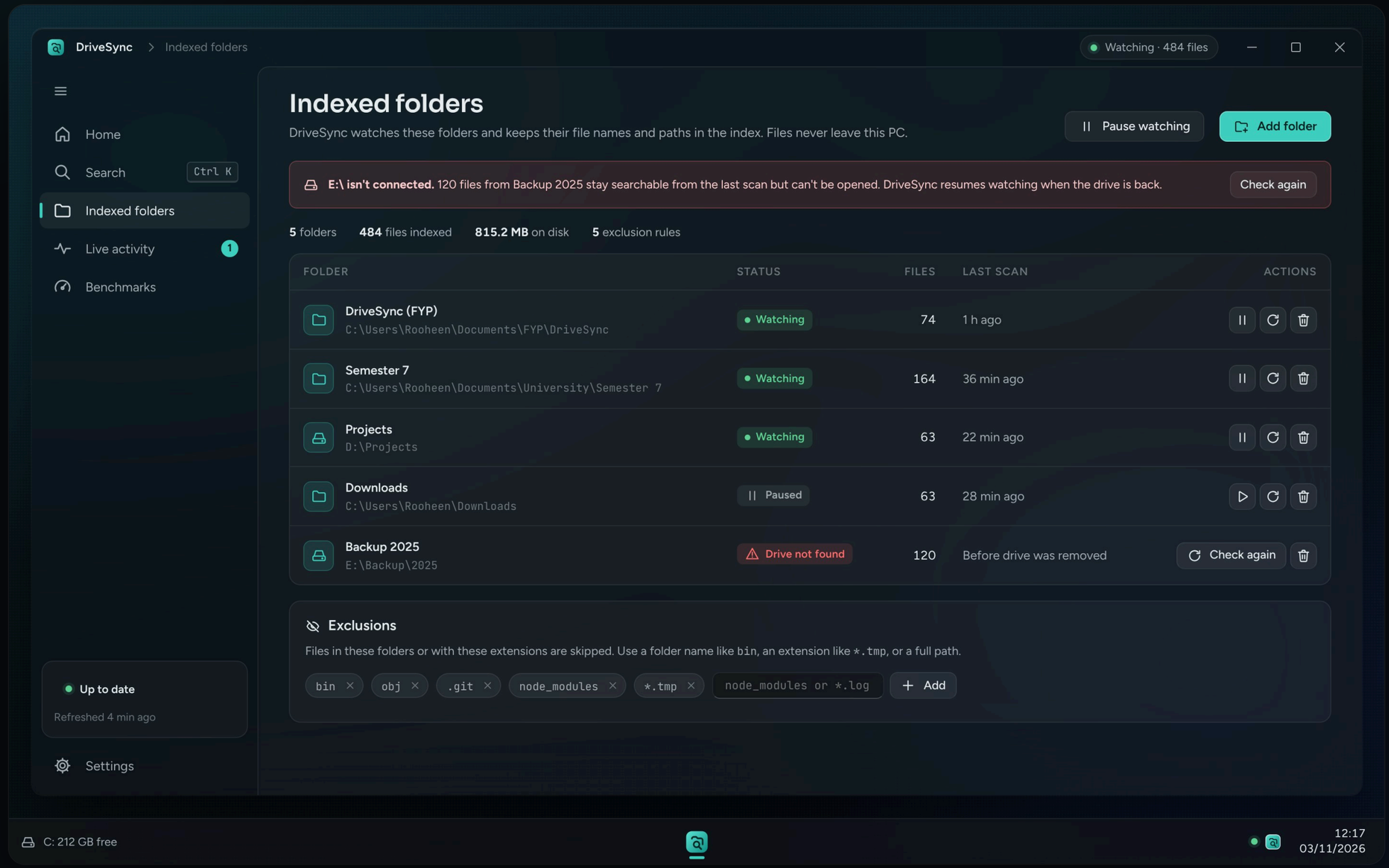
Feedback · toast

Notifications confirm actions and offer undo where it makes sense.



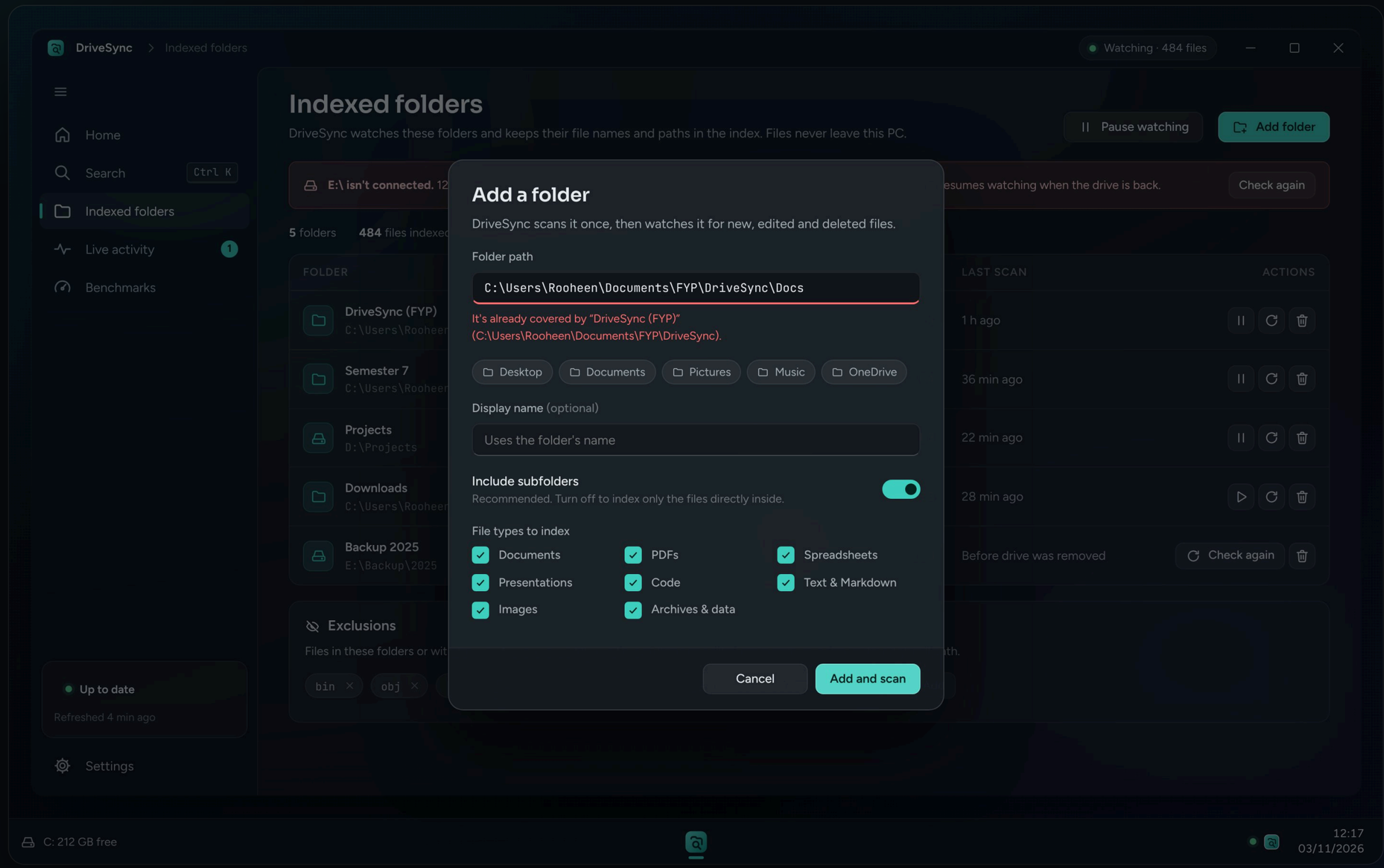
Indexed folders

Watched folders with status, file counts and actions, plus the disconnected-drive banner and exclusion rules.



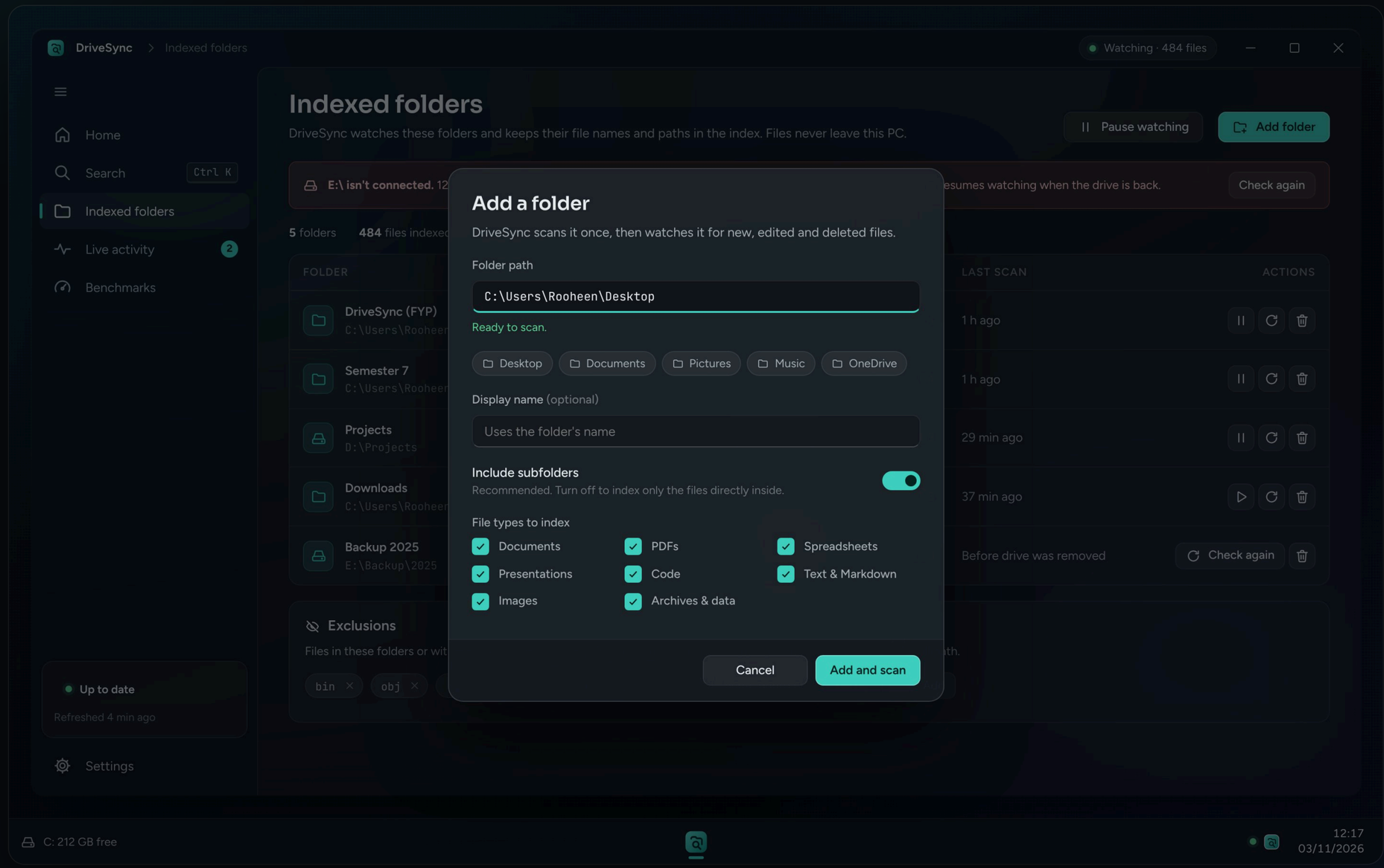
Add folder · validation

Inline validation explains why a path can't be added.



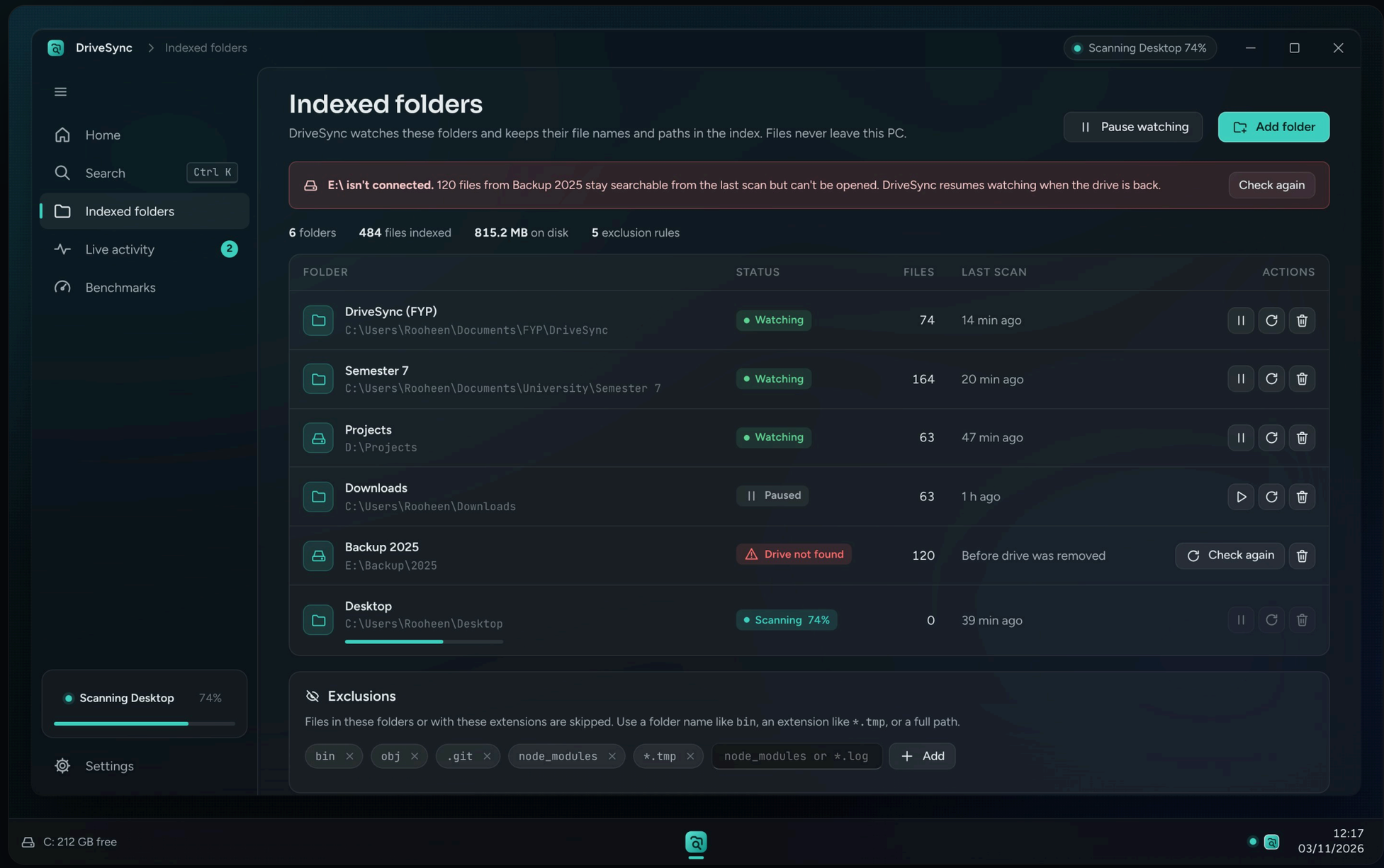
Add folder dialog

Path entry, quick picks, subfolder switch and file-type selection.



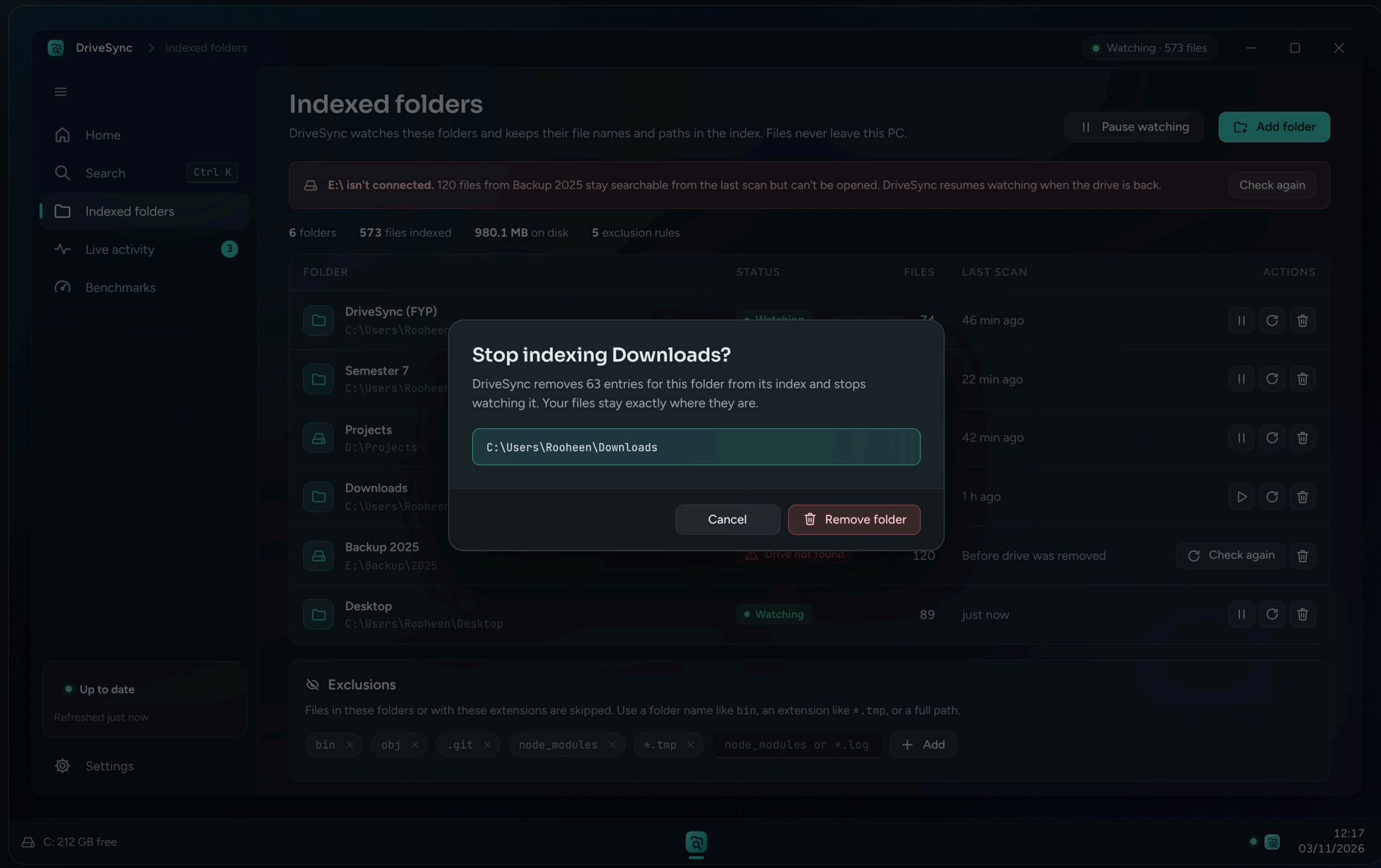
Indexed folders · scanning

A new folder scans with live progress in the table, title bar and navigation.



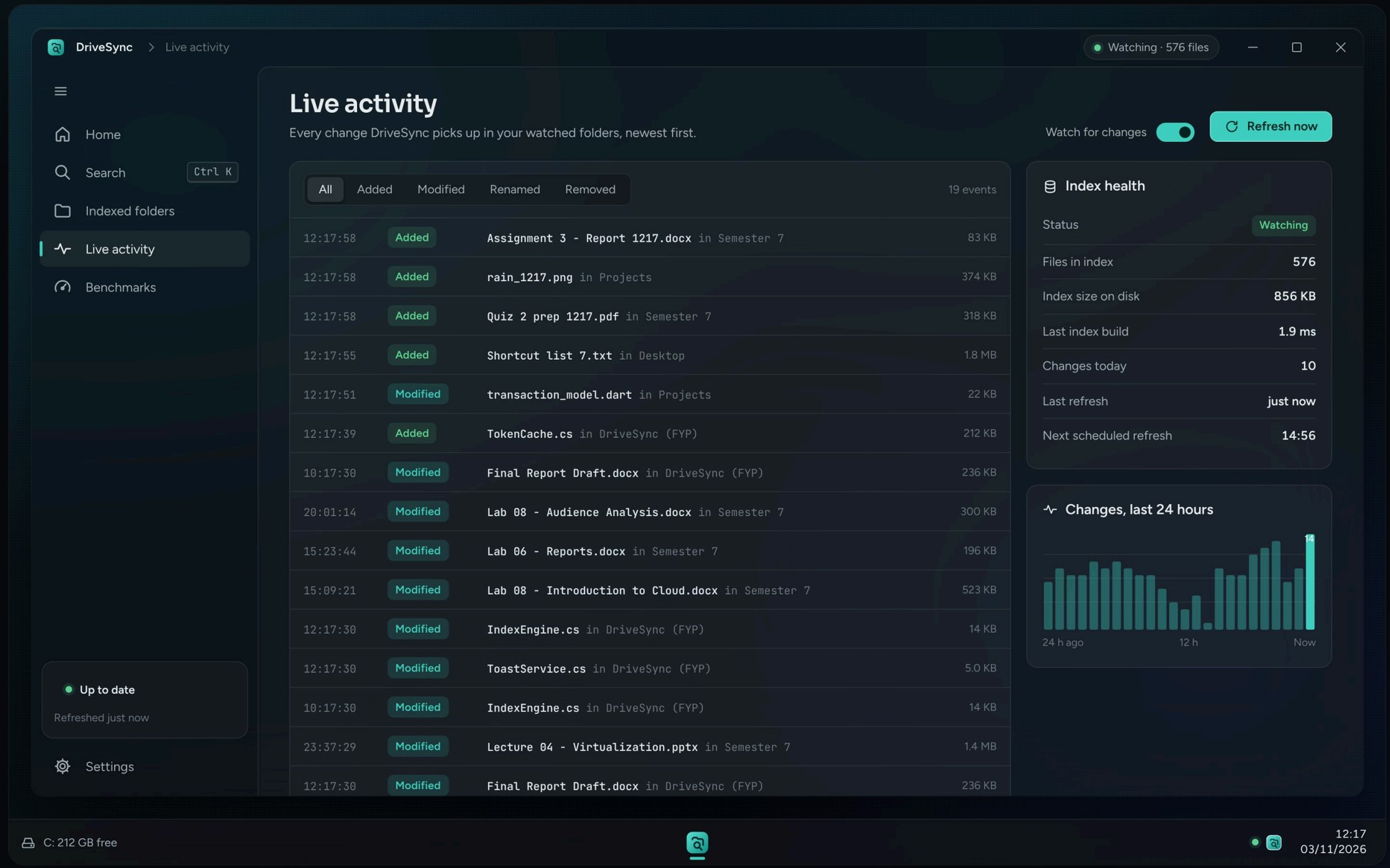
Confirm · remove folder

Destructive actions name exactly what happens and what doesn't.



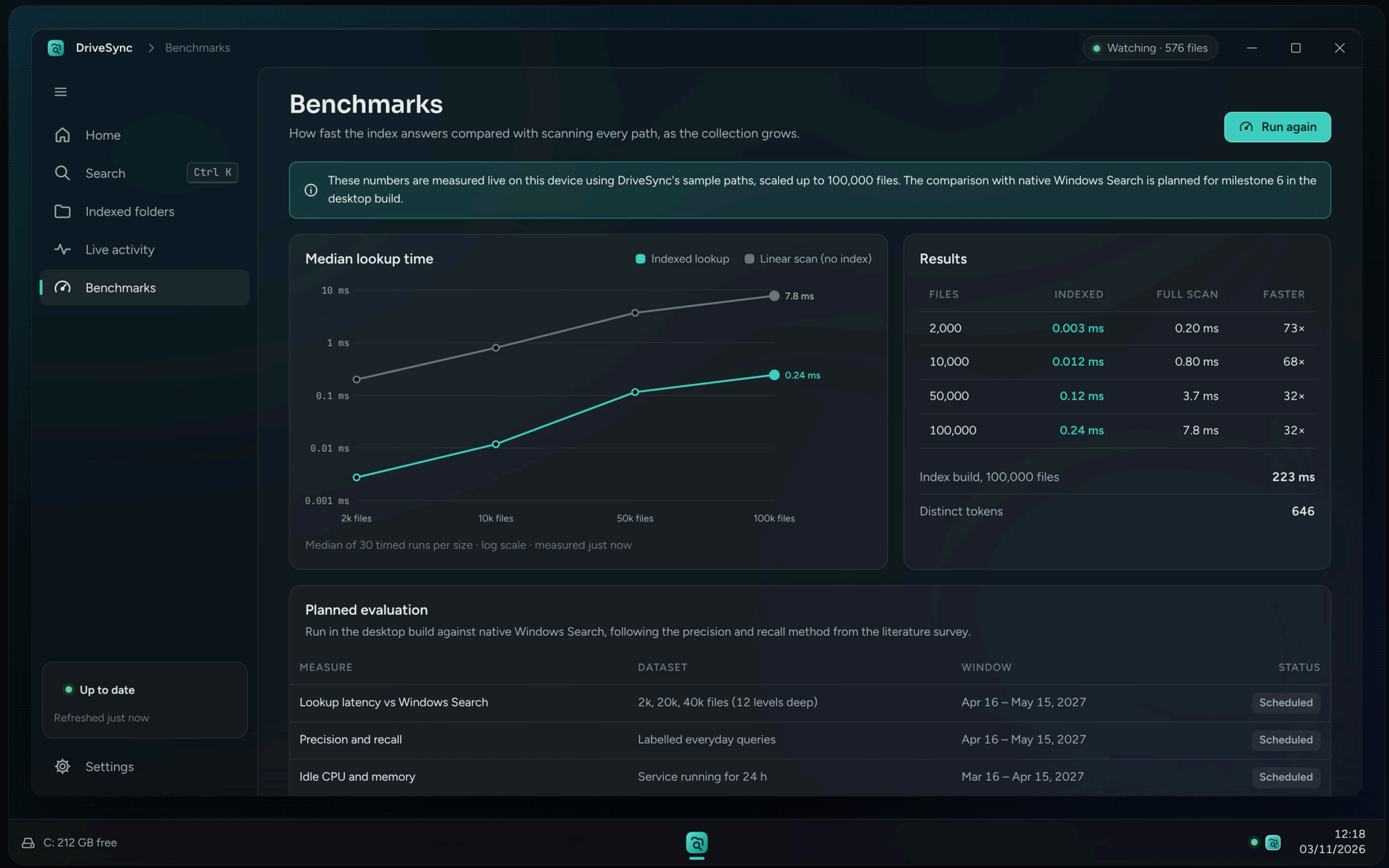
Live activity

Event stream of added, modified, renamed and removed files with index health and a 24-hour chart.



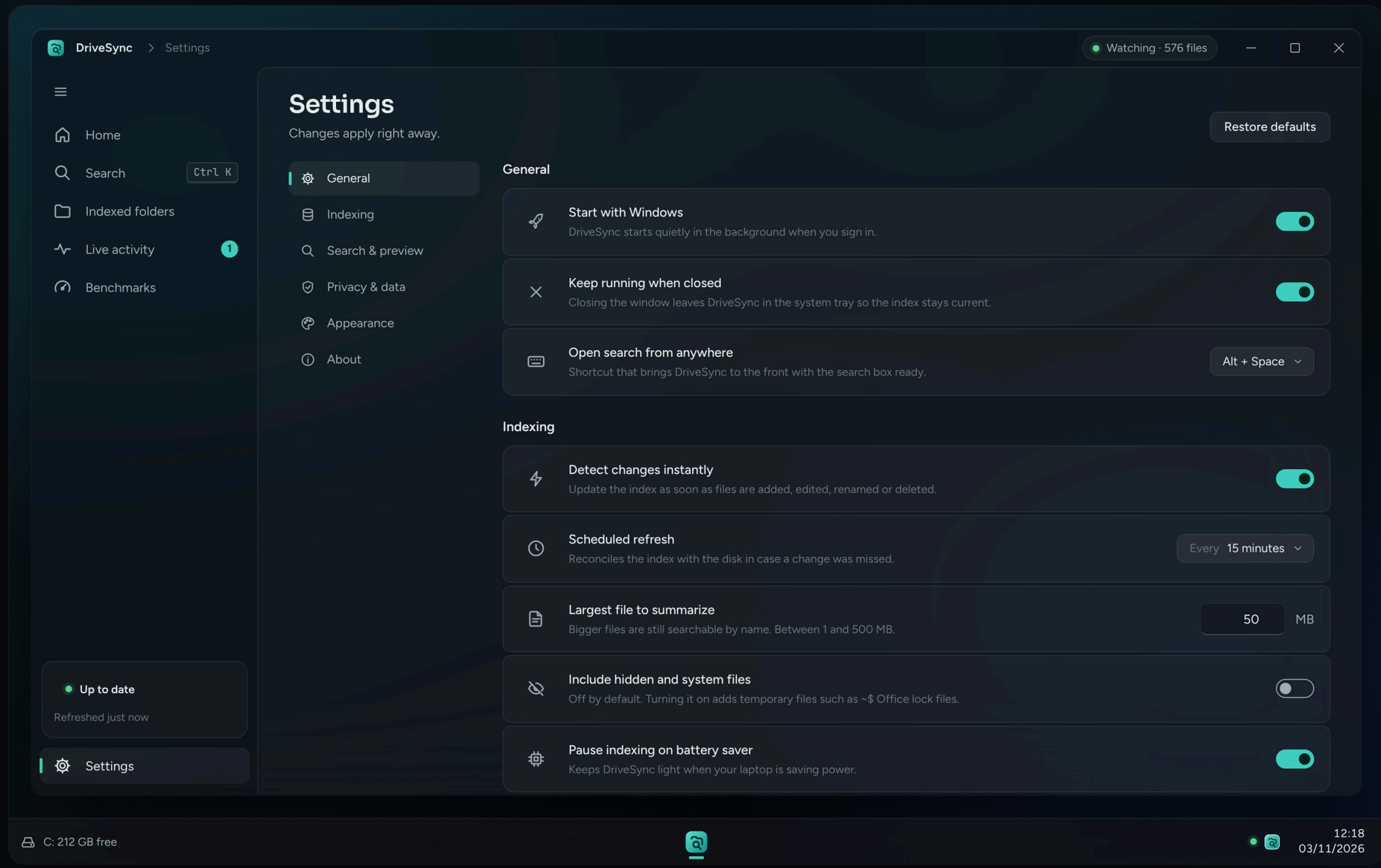
Benchmarks

Live-measured indexed lookup against a full path scan from 2k to 100k files, and the planned evaluation.



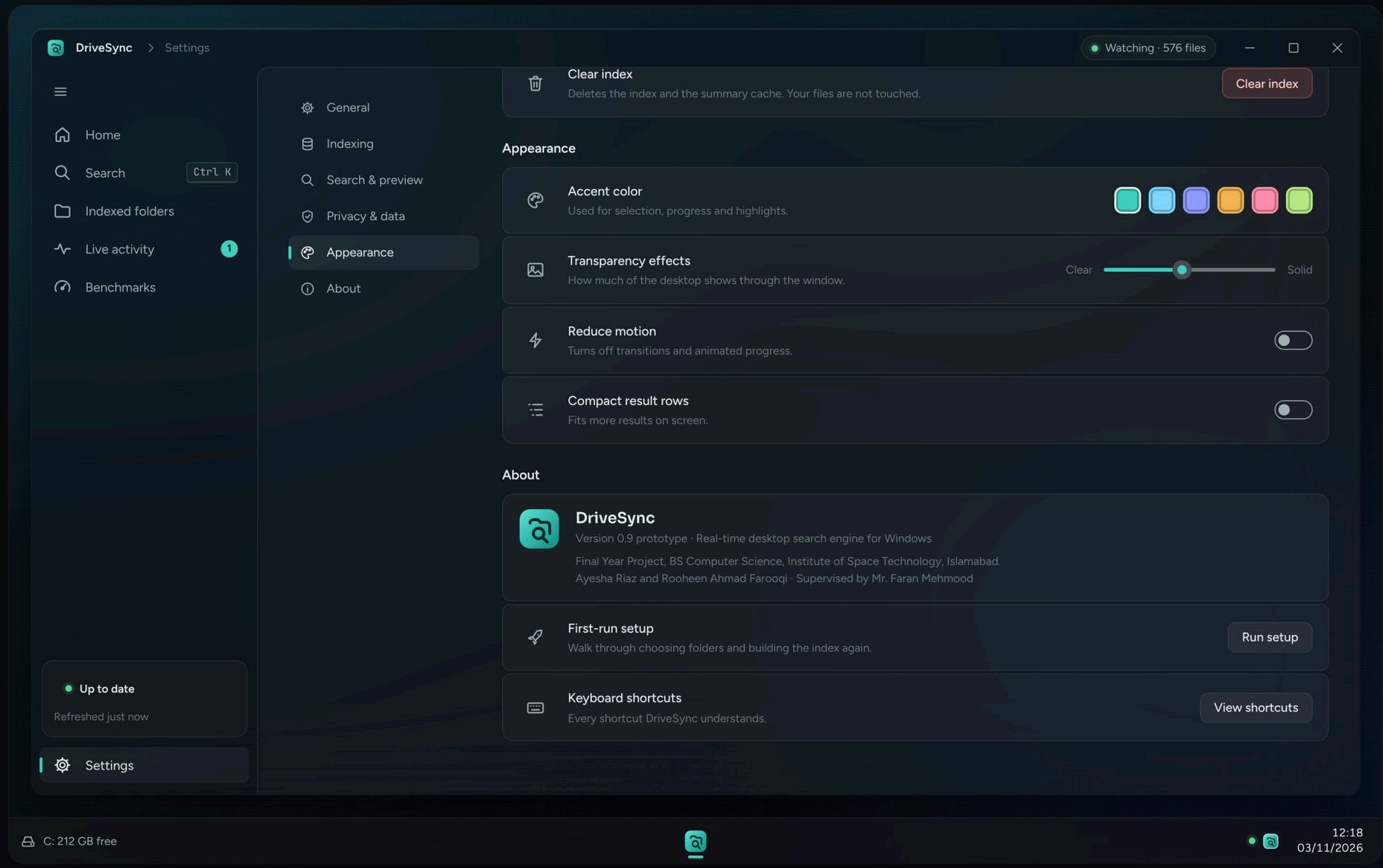
Settings · general & indexing

Windows-style settings cards with switches, menus and validated input.



Settings · privacy & appearance

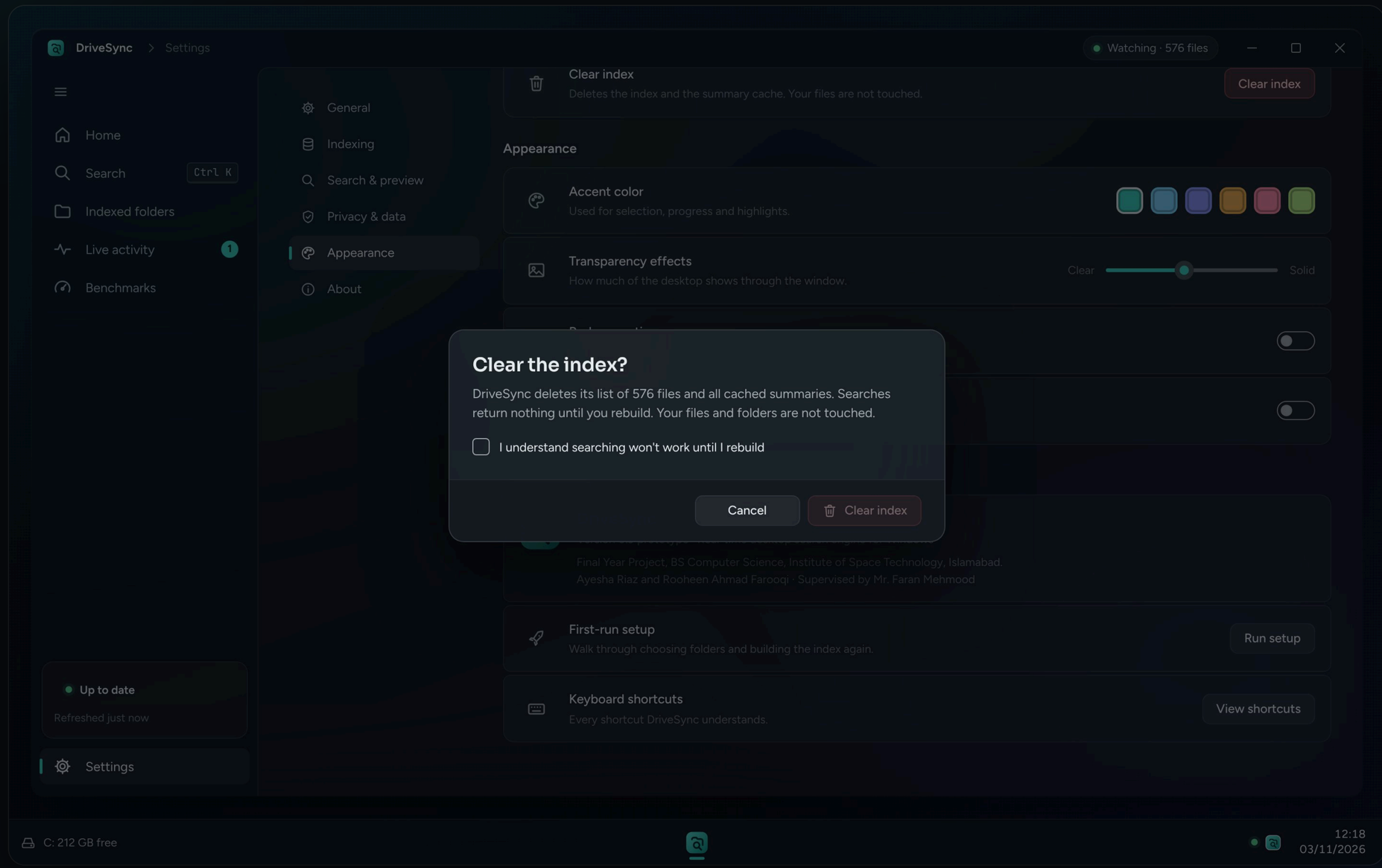
Offline guarantee, index tools, accent colors and transparency.



SETTINGS · 25

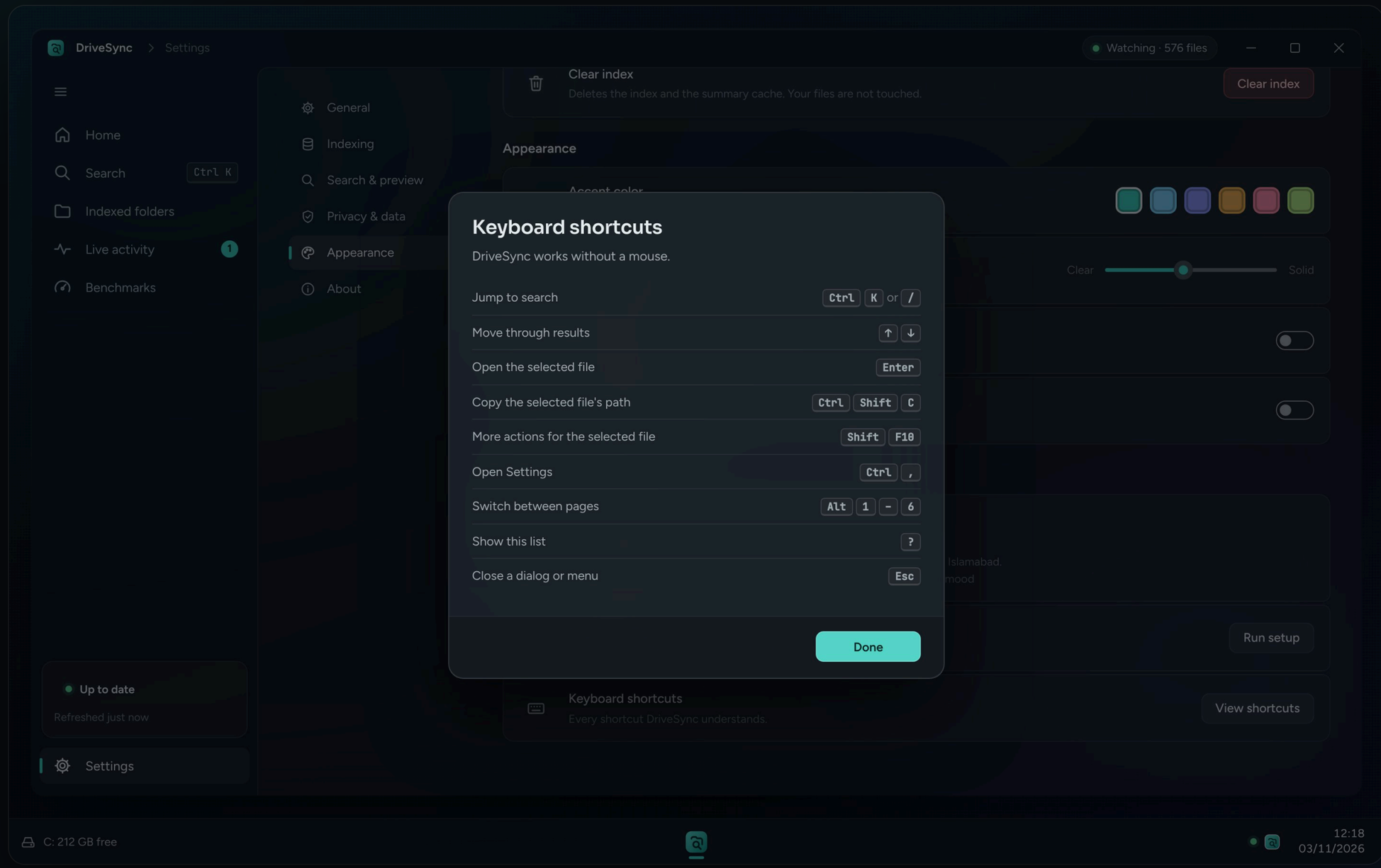
Confirm · clear index

Clearing requires an explicit acknowledgement.



Keyboard shortcuts

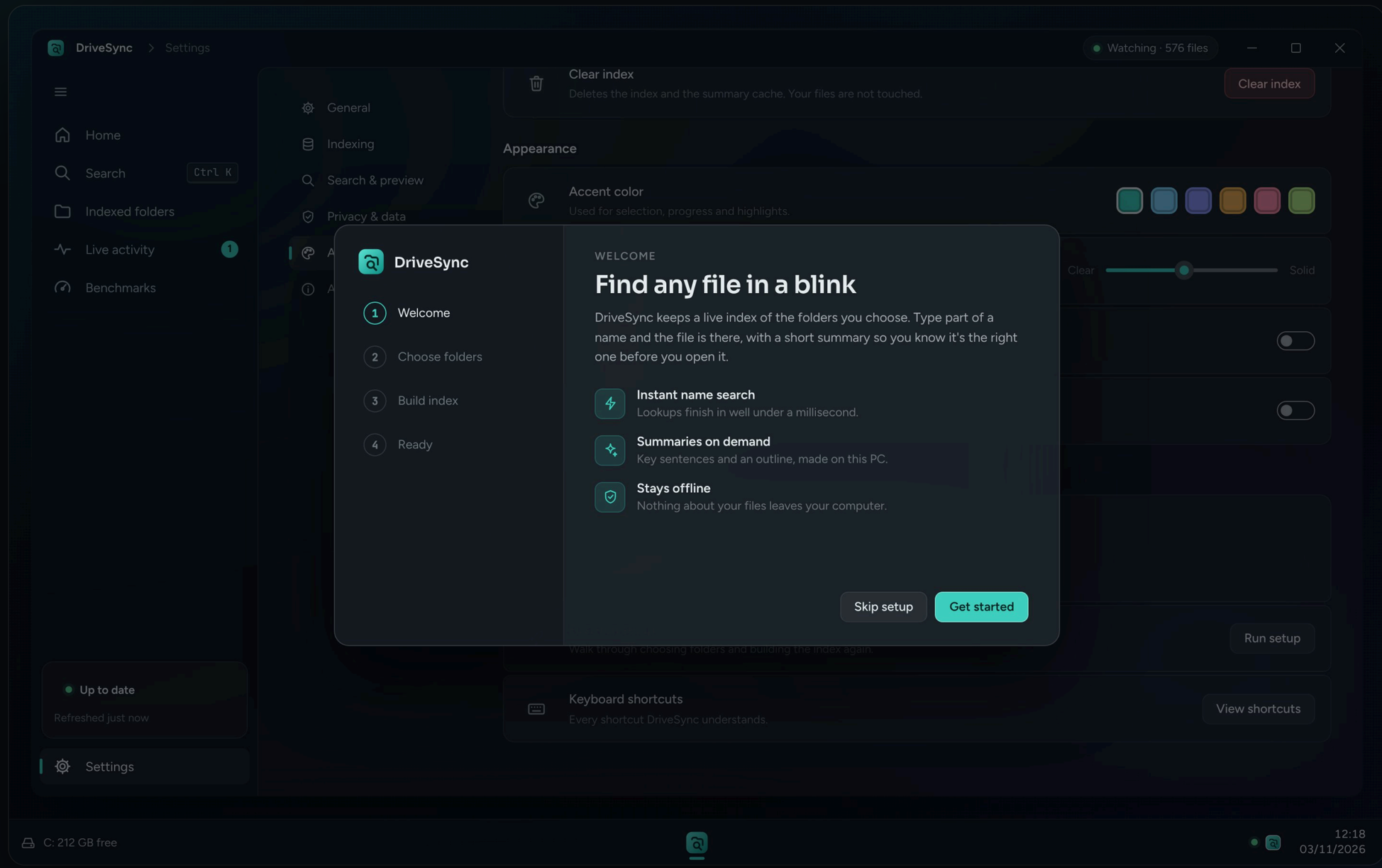
Everything is reachable from the keyboard.



FIRST-RUN SETUP · 27

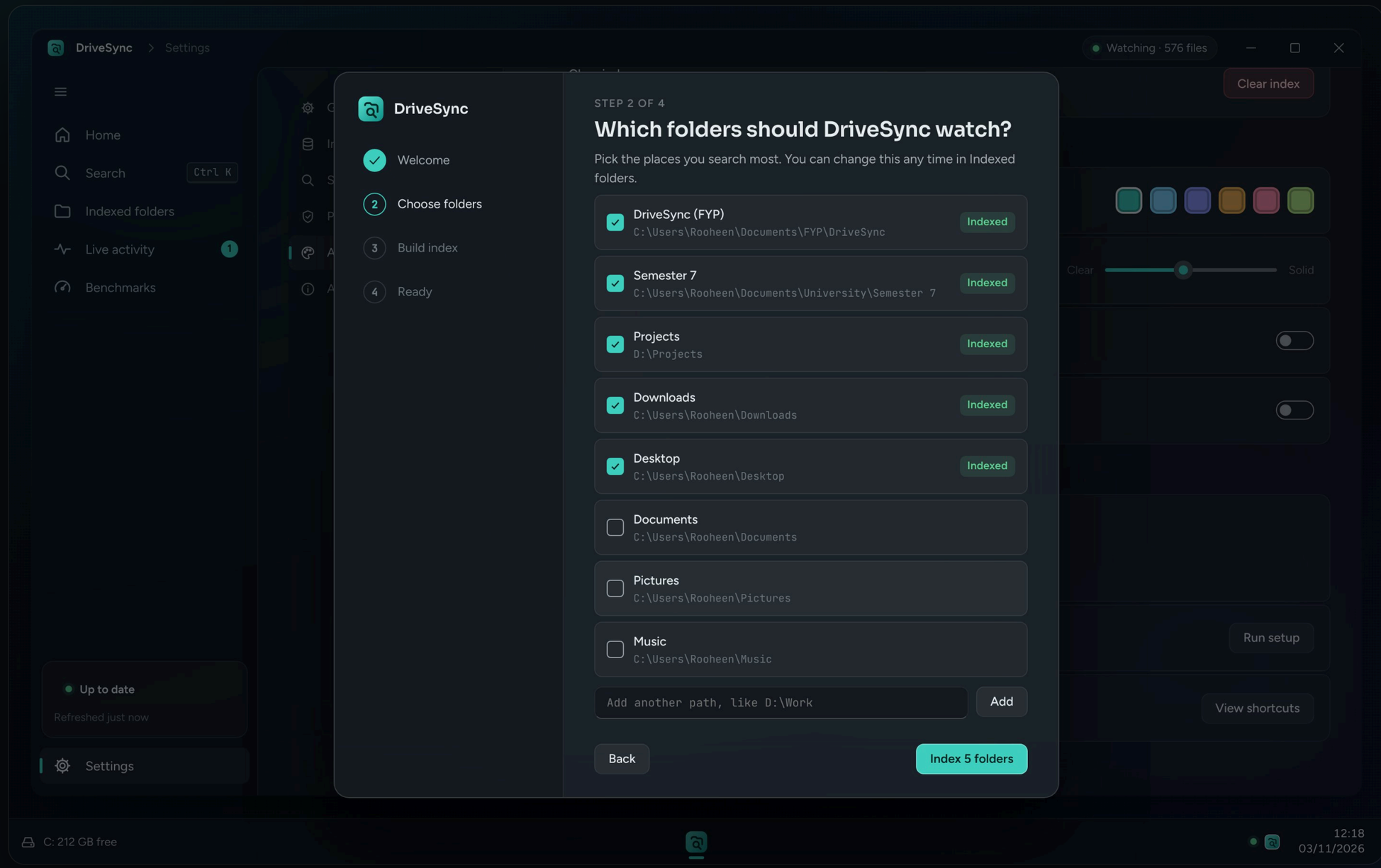
First run · welcome

What DriveSync does, in three lines.



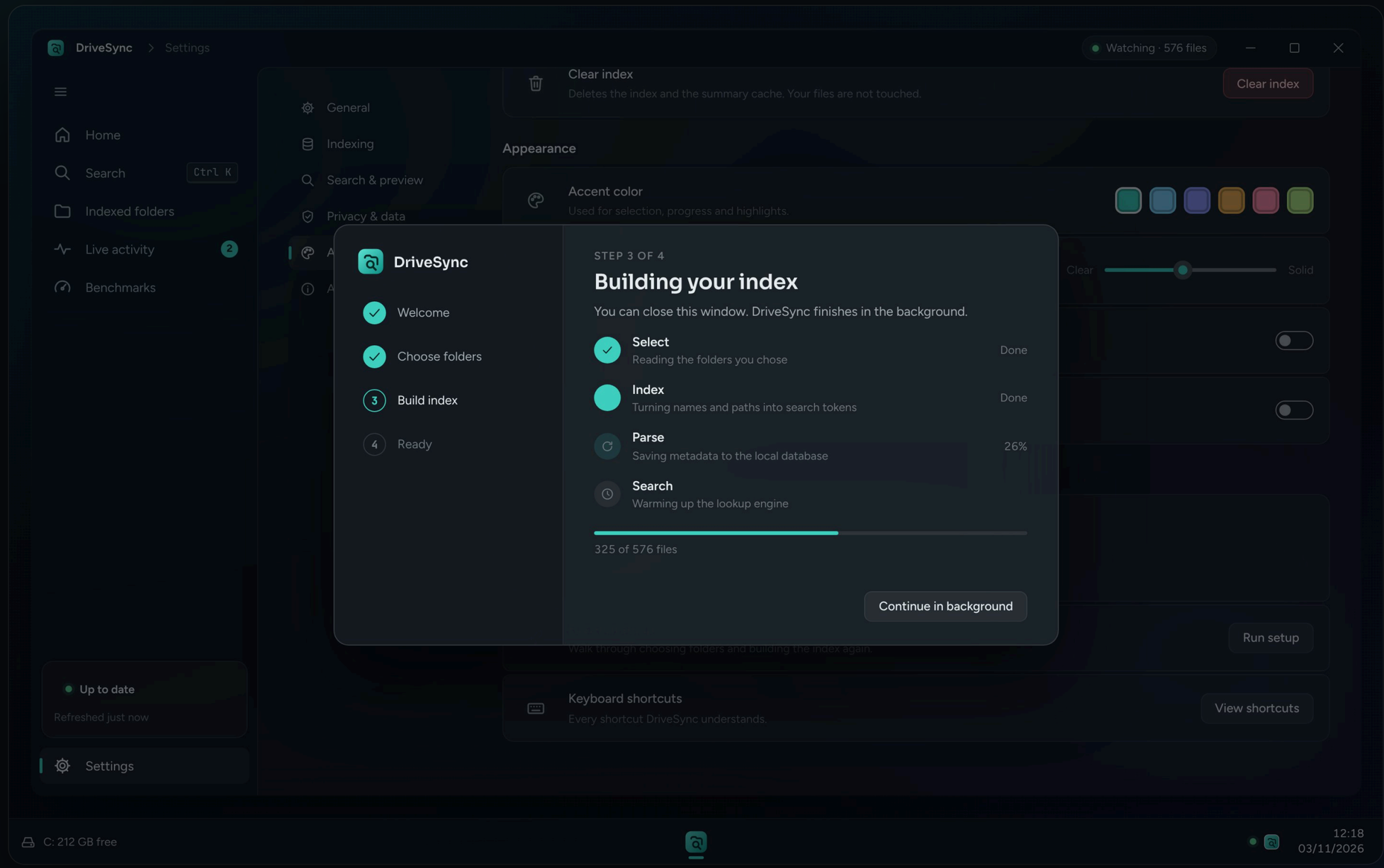
First run · choose folders

Pick folders to watch, or add any path.



First run · building index

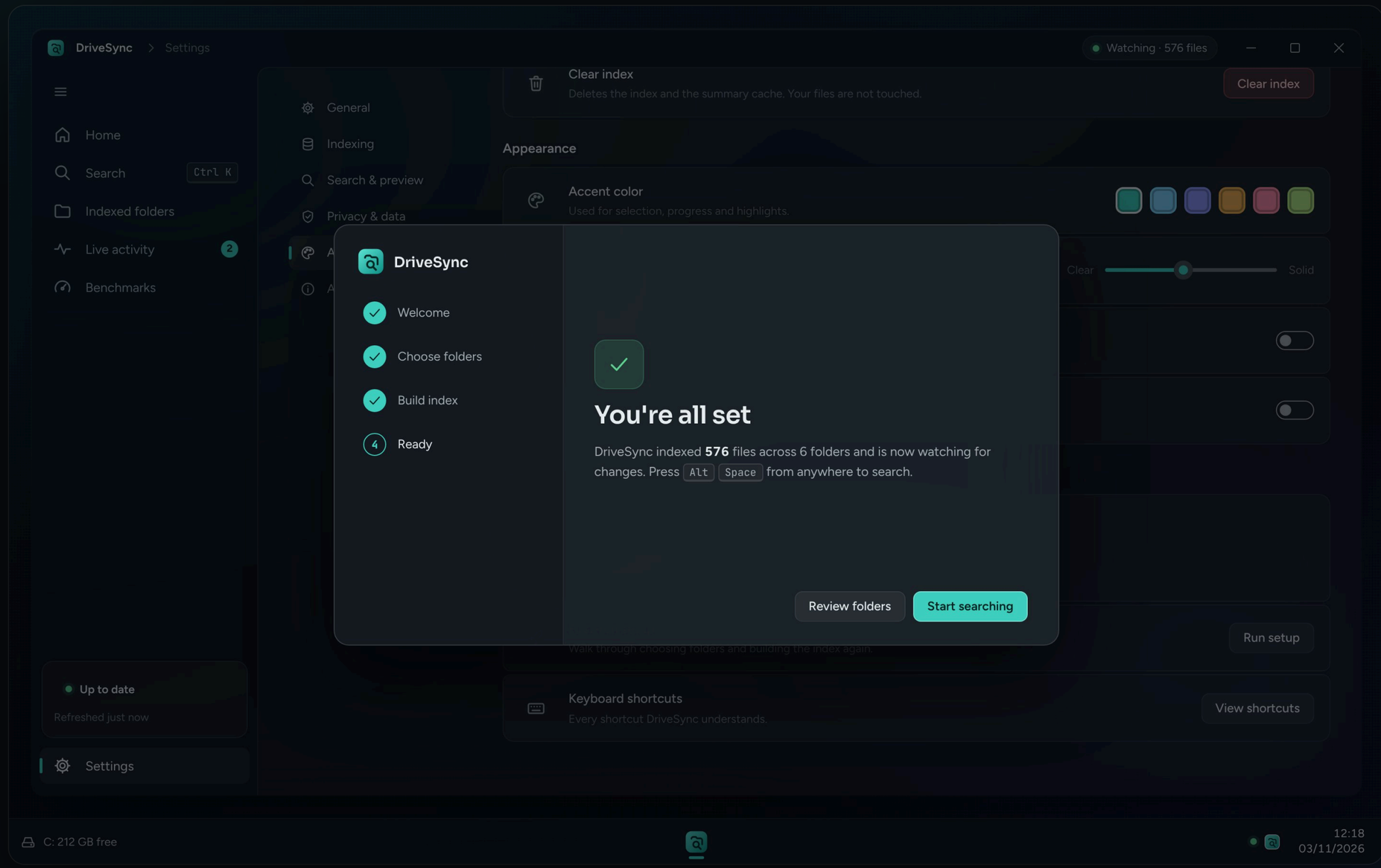
The four pipeline stages run with live progress.



FIRST-RUN SETUP · 30

First run · ready

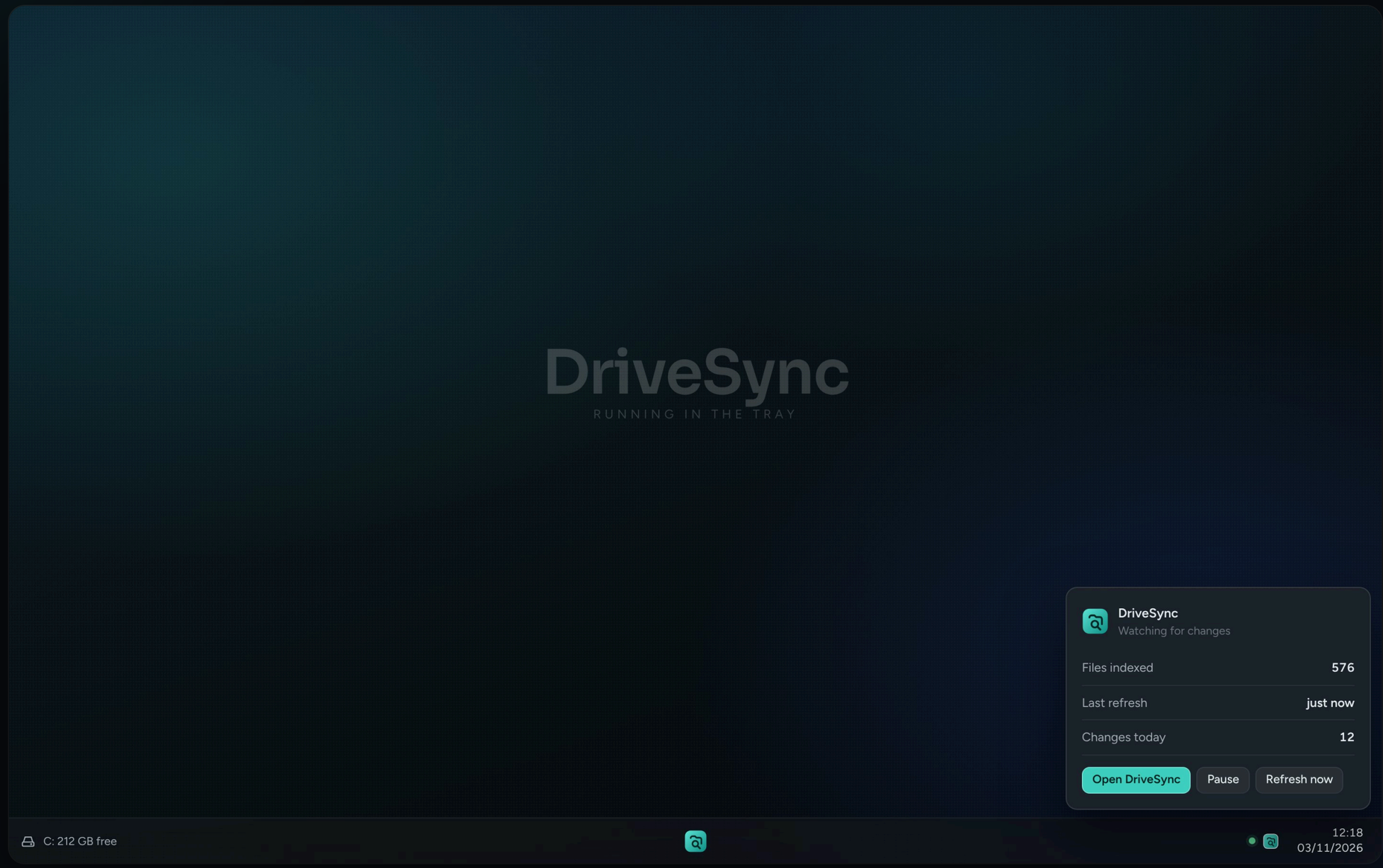
Confirmation and the next step.



WINDOW & SYSTEM · 31

Closed to tray

Closing keeps DriveSync running; the tray flyout shows status and quick actions.



Narrow window

The layout compacts to an icon rail and a sliding preview sheet.

